

1776 · 1787 · 1791 • UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT & CIVICS (GC) • COURSE
STANDARD EDITION

GOVERNMENT HACK™

TROOPTOTEACHER TECHNOLOGIES

UNIT 1

Foundations of Constitutional Government

COURSE STANDARD EDITION

GC.01–GC.09 • Tennessee U.S. Government & Civics Standards • Grades 9–12

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

Tennessee entered the Union in 1796 as the 16th state. Its own state constitution echoes the federal design studied in this unit — a separation of powers among three branches and a Declaration of Rights modeled on the Bill of Rights (GC.06, GC.08).

One common workbook designed for learner variability. Every student works toward the same Tennessee standards; supports vary the means, not the goal or the ceiling.

Release-Ready · Pilot Edition

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Government Hack™ — Unit 1: Foundations of Constitutional Government, Course Standard Edition.

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Source integrity. Every primary source in this unit is public-domain and cited to its holding repository (National Archives, Library of Congress). See the Source Library.

Reading provenance (district-clear). Close-Read passages are labeled “Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis” — they build on the standard record and are not presented as primary sources.

Framework stack. This workbook anchors to Tennessee U.S. Government & Civics standards GC.01–GC.09 and the Social Studies Practices (SSP.01–SSP.06), and is designed on CAST UDL 3.0 and an MTSS support model.

Pacing. Each standard is built for **one 45-minute class period**. Each activity shows a  ~ **minutes** estimate at its heading. There is more here than one period holds — your teacher chooses which activities you do in class; the rest may become warm-ups, stations, or homework.

Table of Contents

Tennessee Standards & SSP Crosswalk

Each standard below is taught to the full Course Standard expectation; the Social Studies Practices are embedded in every activity cycle.

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Social Studies Practices (SSP.01-SSP.06)

SSP.01 Gather/evaluate sources · SSP.02 Critically examine a primary source · SSP.03 Synthesize evidence · SSP.04 Construct/communicate argument · SSP.05 Develop historical awareness · SSP.06 Chronological/spatial reasoning. Each Close Read, Primary Source/Data, and CER activity names the practices it builds.

Accessibility, UDL & Accommodations Matrix

One firm learning goal per standard; flexible, universal means. Supports are available by design and never lower the goal. They work alongside — never in place of — required IEP or 504 accommodations.

Universal support	What it is	Where it appears
CORE PATH	Essential instruction every student completes	Every activity
LANGUAGE SUPPORT	Vocabulary, pronunciation, Spanish cognates	Word Bank, Guided/Light Backs
RESPONSE CHOICE	Write, say/record, or diagram	Every activity
SUPPORT OPTION	Optional scaffold that keeps the goal	Guided Support Back, Primary Source
PROGRESS CHECK	Quick DOK-2/3 check to guide reteach/extend	Cornell Notes, Practice Quiz
EXTENSION	Deeper challenge once the goal is met	Extension Bank, CER

How CAST UDL 3.0 is visible in this workbook

Multiple means of Engagement (response choice, relevance via Tennessee Connection), Representation (Word Bank, pronunciation, Spanish, Close-Read supports), and Action & Expression (write/say/diagram, Frayer, CER). No fixed-track labels appear.

My Support Plan (optional — you choose)

Supports are available by design. Check the ones you might try; you can change your mind any time.

Support I might use	When it would help me
Word Bank + Spanish column	
Guided or Light Support Back	
Response choice (say/record or diagram)	
Sentence frames / Rehearsal Lab	

How to Use This Workbook

Each standard runs the same seven-activity cycle: (1) Vocabulary Word Bank, (2) Vocabulary Studio, (3) Direct-Teaching Cornell Notes with optional Guided and Light Support Backs, (4) Close Read, (5) Primary Source / Data Analysis, (6) Core Application Practice Quiz, (7) Constructed Response (CER). Work the CORE PATH; reach for SUPPORT OPTIONS as needed.

Label legend — these appear throughout every standard cycle

Label	Meaning
CORE PATH	The essential instruction every student completes.
SUPPORT OPTION	An optional scaffold that keeps the goal, not lowers it.
LANGUAGE SUPPORT	Vocabulary, pronunciation, and Spanish cognates for access.
RESPONSE CHOICE	Show learning by writing, saying/recording, or diagramming.
PROGRESS CHECK	A quick DOK-2/3 check that guides reteach or extend.
EXTENSION	A deeper challenge once the goal is met.

Before You Begin — Set a S.M.A.R.T. Goal

Strong learners set goals — but a goal only helps if it is built well. First learn how, then write yours.

WHAT MAKES A GOAL STRONG? Build it S.M.A.R.T.

S — Specific: say exactly what you will be able to do (“explain how a bill becomes law,” not “do well”).

M — Measurable: how will you PROVE it? — a score, a diagram, or teaching a partner.

A — Achievable: a real stretch you can reach with effort — not too easy, not impossible.

R — Relevant: it connects to this unit’s big question.

T — Time-bound: name WHEN — “by the end of this unit.”

SEE THE DIFFERENCE

Weak: “I want to do good in government.” (vague — nothing to measure)

S.M.A.R.T.: “By the end of this unit I can explain how the three branches check each other, and prove it by teaching a partner and scoring 80%+ on the check.”

This unit’s big question: How and why did the Founders build a limited constitutional republic?

BUILD YOURS — write each piece on the lines, then combine them at the bottom

Fill in each part of your goal. Use the lines.

Part of my goal	Write your piece on the lines
S — Specific: what exactly will I be able to do?	_____ _____
M — Measurable: how will I prove it? (a score, a diagram, teaching a partner)	_____ _____
A — Achievable: what effort will it take to reach it?	_____ _____
R — Relevant: how does it connect to the big question above?	_____ _____
T — Time-bound: by when?	_____ _____

PUT IT TOGETHER — my S.M.A.R.T. goal in one or two sentences:

Standard GC.01 — Enlightenment Roots of American Government

TN Academic Standard GC.01: Examine the influences of leading European thinkers (e.g., John Locke, Charles-Louis Montesquieu, Thomas Hobbes) and other roots of American government (e.g., Greek democracy, Roman Republic, Magna Carta). (C, E)

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can examine the influences of leading European thinkers (e.g., John Locke, Charles-Louis Montesquieu, Thomas Hobbes) and other roots of American government (e.g., Greek democracy, Roman Republic, Magna Carta)..

Lenses for this standard: Culture (C) · Economics (E)

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Every student works this standard at the same rigor: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER. Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page. Supports for each step are on the back of this page.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it? (Need help? See the back of this page.)

HOOK — think before you dig in

You already have rights no ruler gave you and none can take away — that's the idea that started a revolution. Where did it come from?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — before you dig in (you'll revisit this at the end)

In your own words: what do you think this standard is about, and why might it matter to you or your community? Write 2-3 sentences.

Getting Started — supports for this page — GC.01

WHAT “CORE PATH” MEANS

Everyone learns the same standard at the same level. “Support options” are just extra ways in — sentence starters, an example, a partner, or recording your answer. They help you reach the bar; they never lower it.

SET YOUR GOAL — how to write a strong one

Example goal: “By the end of this standard I can explain ___ and prove it by scoring 80%+ on the quiz.”

How to build it: name what you’ll DO, then how you’ll PROVE it, then WHEN.

Sentence starters: “I want to be able to...” “I’ll show it by...” “By the end of this standard...”

HOOK — sentence starters

“I think the big question is...” “This connects to...” “I wonder why...” “At first I believe...”

ACTIVATE — what it means & how to answer

What it means: “Activate” = wake up what you ALREADY know before you learn more.

Sentence starters: “I already know...” “This reminds me of...” “I want to find out...”

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — what to write

Just your honest first take — there is no wrong answer. Say what you THINK the standard is about and why it might matter to you, your family, or your community. You’ll come back and improve it at the end.

KEY WORDS TO WATCH FOR

Natural Rights · Social Contract · Magna Carta

NOW TRY IT — draft your goal using a starter above

Write a first draft here, then copy your best version onto the front. Aim for: what you’ll DO + how you’ll PROVE it + WHEN.

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — GC.01 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Natural Rights	God-given rights to life, liberty, and property that government does not grant and cannot rightfully take away — central to John Locke's political thought.	derechos naturales
Social Contract	The idea that people agree to give up some freedom to a government in exchange for protection of their rights, and that government's authority comes from the consent of the governed.	contrato social
Magna Carta	The 1215 English charter that limited the king's power and protected certain rights of life, liberty, and property — an early root of limited government and due process.	Carta Magna

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Natural Rights (NATCH-rul RYTS); Social Contract (SOH-shul KON-trakt); Magna Carta (MAG-nuh KAR-tuh).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK · Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 · never seen it	2 · heard it	3 · can use it	4 · can teach it
Natural Rights	_____	_____	_____	_____
Social Contract	_____	_____	_____	_____
Magna Carta	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

QUICK WRITE

Which of these terms do you think will matter MOST for this standard, and why? You'll revisit this at the end.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — GC.01

~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE — three ways to complete each studio**WRITE:** fill in the four boxes below in your own words.**SAY IT:** explain the term aloud to a partner or your teacher, or record a short voice note — say the term, its meaning, and one example.**DIAGRAM:** sketch or map the term in the Sketch Studio on the back of this page.**PRIORITY TERM 1 Natural Rights** · ES: derechos naturales**Word-bank meaning to build on:** God-given rights to life, liberty, and property that government does not grant and cannot rightfully take away — central to John Locke's political thought.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Natural Rights” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 Social Contract · ES: contrato social**Word-bank meaning to build on:** The idea that people agree to give up some freedom to a government in exchange for protection of their rights, and that government's authority comes from the consent of the governed.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Social Contract” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL · build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write how one leads to or affects another on the lines — or map it in the Sketch Studio on the back.

Activity 2 — Sketch Studio (draw it or say it) — GC.01

SAY IT — pick one way to explain your terms aloud

Explain each priority term to a shoulder partner, then have them explain one back to you.

Or explain a term to your teacher during check-in.

Or record a 20–30 second voice note: say the term, what it means, and one real example.

Or stand and share one term with the class.

DIAGRAM: Natural Rights

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

DIAGRAM: Social Contract

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

CONNECT THE TERMS — concept map

Put both terms in the box and draw arrows to show how one leads to, needs, or affects the other. Write a few words on each arrow.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — GC.01 ~20 min

GC.01 — Enlightenment Roots of American Government • Lean Student Deck slides 2-8 • direct-teaching slides 4-6

Your learning targets are on this standard's opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Guiding cues	My notes — write your notes here
Key idea of this standard?	
One primary source that supports it?	
One effect on government or rights?	
Key terms →	

DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL · another way in)

Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — GC.01

UDL · CHOOSE HOW YOU CAPTURE IDEAS (same target for everyone)

Keep going with your notes: WRITE on the lines, DRAW or diagram in the box, or do both — your choice. You may also record your notes aloud.

DRAW / DIAGRAM — sketch the idea, a timeline, or how the pieces connect

WRITE — keep taking notes on the lines

Key terms to list

Natural Rights · Social Contract · Magna Carta

Summary — In your own words (2-3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK · one question

According to John Locke, where does a government's rightful authority come from?

- A. The divine right of kings
- B. The strongest military
- C. The consent of the people being governed
- D. Inherited wealth and land

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ **1**

My 12-15 word headline for this standard

Guided Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.01

These scaffolds support ONLY the Cornell notes — use them to take and process those notes. Optional and easy to set aside; not a separate assignment or a label.

Key vocabulary	What it means
Natural Rights	God-given rights to life, liberty, and property that government does not grant and cannot rightfully take away — central to John Locke's political thought.
Social Contract	The idea that people agree to give up some freedom to a government in exchange for protection of their rights, and that government's authority comes from the consent of the governed.
Magna Carta	The 1215 English charter that limited the king's power and protected certain rights of life, liberty, and property — an early root of limited government and due process.

Break it into steps:

1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of enlightenment roots of american government was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of enlightenment roots of american government was Natural Rights: God-given rights to life, liberty, and property that government does not grant and cannot rightfully take away — central to John Locke's political thought.

GUIDED NOTE REHEARSAL LAB — practice ONE note, step by step

Build one good note here first, then copy it onto your Cornell page. Name the idea → give one piece of evidence → explain the link → write a short headline.

Step	Rehearse it here
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____
Explain	_____ _____
Headline	_____ _____

TRANSFER CHECK — move one rehearsed idea onto the front notes

Light Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.01

A lighter scaffold for the SAME Cornell notes. Try the notes first; reach for this only if you need it.

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Natural Rights	
Social Contract	
Magna Carta	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below (or in your front notes):

- According to Locke, what rights do people have simply by being born, and what is government's job regarding them?
- What limit on the king's power does Magna Carta's Clause 39 establish, and how does it connect to due process today?
- Why does the text say the colonists used 'old ideas, not new ones' to justify independence?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?

Circle the Cornell cue from the front page you still need help with, and tell your teacher so we can go over it.

LIGHT PROCESSING LAB

Answer one guiding question from above in a full sentence, in your own words.

Activity 4 — Close Read — GC.01 ⌚ ~15 min

Reading type: Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH

American ideas about liberty and self-government were not new in 1776 — they grew from older roots. John Locke argued that people are born with natural rights to life, liberty, and property, and that government exists by a social contract to protect them, losing its authority if it fails. Montesquieu urged dividing government power among separate branches; Hobbes explained why people trade some freedom for order. Older models mattered too: Greek democracy, the Roman republic, and the limits on rulers set in Magna Carta (1215) and the English Bill of Rights (1689). The colonists inherited these ideas and reshaped them.

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Key terms to know first: Natural Rights, Social Contract. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

Text-dependent questions (answer in the Evidence Lab below or aloud):

1. According to Locke, what rights do people have simply by being born, and what is government's job regarding them?
2. What limit on the king's power does Magna Carta's Clause 39 establish, and how does it connect to due process today?
3. Why does the text say the colonists used 'old ideas, not new ones' to justify independence?

RESPONSE CHOICE: answer any question by writing in the Evidence Lab, saying/recording it, or diagramming it.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB

Log evidence from the passage below.

Question / claim	Exact passage evidence	What the evidence shows

In one sentence — the main idea of this reading:

Spaced Retrieval & Reflection — GC.01

SPACED RETRIEVAL — quick recall (no notes)

Pull it up cold to strengthen memory, then check your notes — retrieval is what makes learning stick.

Recall prompt

Your answer (from memory)

One key term or fact from THIS standard

One thing you learned in an EARLIER standard — how does it connect?

One question you can answer now that you could not before

CHECK YOURSELF — look back and score how it went

Got it right? ☐ Yes ☐ Partly ☐ Not yet **Answer it from memory?** ☐ Yes ☐ With a hint ☐ No

How did it feel? ☐ Confident ☐ Getting there ☐ Shaky — I'll revisit

CONNECT IT — spiral back

How does this standard connect to one you studied earlier, or to something in the world today? Write 2-3 sentences.

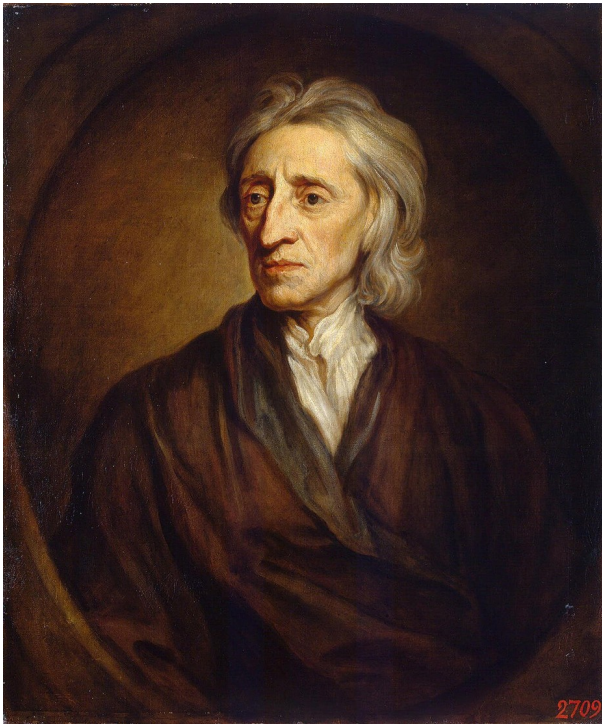
WHERE AM I? — plan your next step

Rate your understanding of this standard (1-4): ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

One thing I will review or ask about before the quiz:

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — GC.01 ~15 min

Primary source (oil portrait) — analyze it with HIPPO. Builds SSP.01–SSP.02.



Portrait of John Locke · Sir Godfrey Kneller · 1697

Source: public domain (artist d. 1723) · [https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Godfrey_Kneller_-_Portrait_of_John_Locke_\(Hermitage\).jpg](https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Godfrey_Kneller_-_Portrait_of_John_Locke_(Hermitage).jpg) Public domain — artist d.1723 (PD-old/PD-US) [https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Godfrey_Kneller_-_Portrait_of_John_Locke_\(Hermitage\).jpg](https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Godfrey_Kneller_-_Portrait_of_John_Locke_(Hermitage).jpg)

FIRST LOOK — before you analyze
Jot 3–4 things you notice in the source (details, words, people, dates). No wrong answers.

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

Primary Source Analysis — go deeper — GC.01

SUPPORT OPTION (use if you need it)

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

SOURCE SYNTHESIS — put it together (SSP.03)

In 2–3 sentences: what does this source reveal about this standard, and how do you know? Cite one specific detail from it.

THINK LIKE A HISTORIAN — corroborate or challenge (SSP.03)

Name ONE other source that could CONFIRM this one, and ONE way it could COMPLICATE or CHALLENGE it — or, whose voice is missing here?

SO WHAT? — why this source still matters today

In 1–2 sentences: why does this source still matter for understanding government today?

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit:

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — GC.01 ⌚ ~8 min**RESPONSE CHOICE**

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 1 • item u1-gc01-dok1-1 • pre-field-test]

Which thinker is most associated with natural rights and the social contract?

- A. Thomas Hobbes
- B. John Locke
- C. Julius Caesar
- D. King John

[DOK 2 • item u1-gc01-dok2-tc • pre-field-test]

According to John Locke, where does a government's rightful authority come from?

- A. The divine right of kings
- B. The strongest military
- C. The consent of the people being governed
- D. Inherited wealth and land

STRETCH — think like a test-writer (open to all)

Write your OWN DOK-3 question for this standard, then a one-sentence answer key. Use the supports below — everyone can do this.

HOW TO WRITE A DOK-3 QUESTION (supports)

DOK-3 = strategic thinking: the reader must analyze, compare, evaluate, or justify using evidence — and there should be more than one defensible answer (not a fact you can just look up).

Sentence starters: “Why did _____ lead to _____?” • “Which mattered more — _____ or _____ — and why?” • “What is the BEST evidence that _____?” • “Evaluate whether _____.” • “Defend or challenge: _____.”

Frame: [Analyze / Evaluate / Justify] + [something from THIS standard] + “using evidence.”

Quick check: does my question make the reader THINK and use evidence? If yes, it's DOK-3.

NOW WRITE YOUR DOK-3 QUESTION HERE

YOUR ANSWER KEY — one clear, defensible sentence

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — GC.01 ~15 min

BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER (before you write) — How and why did the Founders build a limited constitutional republic?

Plan your argument here, then use it to write your claim, evidence, and reasoning below.

Plan your argument

Your quick notes (from this standard)

My claim (answer the prompt)

Evidence 1 (a source or fact)

Reasoning (why it proves the claim)

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Which European root — Locke's natural rights, Montesquieu's separated powers, or Magna Carta's limits on the king — shaped American government the most? Defend your claim with evidence from two sources.

Part

Write here

Claim

Evidence (two specifics)

Reasoning

Constructed Response — self-grade & supports — GC.01

SELF-GRADE — score your own CER against the rubric below

Reread your response, then circle the level that best fits each part. Being honest here is how you level up.

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
4 — Strong	Precise, defensible	2+ accurate, specific	Explains HOW evidence proves the claim
3 — Proficient	Clear	2 accurate	Explains the link
2 — Developing	General	1 accurate	Partial link
1 — Beginning	Unclear / missing	Missing / inaccurate	No reasoning

MY SCORE

Claim: ____ / 4 Evidence: ____ / 4 Reasoning: ____ / 4 TOTAL: ____ / 12

SUPPORTS — sentence frames (use if you need them)

Claim: “_____ because _____.”

Evidence: “One example is _____ (from _____). Another is _____.”

Reasoning: “This proves my claim because _____, which shows _____.”

REVISE — make your lowest-scoring part stronger

Pick the part you scored lowest and rewrite it here — better:

Standard GC.02 — The Declaration of Independence

TN Academic Standard GC.02: Examine the Declaration of Independence and American grievances against British rule. (H)

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can examine the Declaration of Independence and American grievances against British rule..

Lenses for this standard: History (H)

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Every student works this standard at the same rigor: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER. Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page. Supports for each step are on the back of this page.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it? (Need help? See the back of this page.)

HOOK — think before you dig in

'All men are created equal.' A bold claim in 1776 — and the colonists used it to fire a king. How does the Declaration build its case?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — before you dig in (you'll revisit this at the end)

In your own words: what do you think this standard is about, and why might it matter to you or your community? Write 2-3 sentences.

Getting Started — supports for this page — GC.02

WHAT “CORE PATH” MEANS

Everyone learns the same standard at the same level. “Support options” are just extra ways in — sentence starters, an example, a partner, or recording your answer. They help you reach the bar; they never lower it.

SET YOUR GOAL — how to write a strong one

Example goal: “By the end of this standard I can explain ___ and prove it by scoring 80%+ on the quiz.”

How to build it: name what you’ll DO, then how you’ll PROVE it, then WHEN.

Sentence starters: “I want to be able to...” “I’ll show it by...” “By the end of this standard...”

HOOK — sentence starters

“I think the big question is...” “This connects to...” “I wonder why...” “At first I believe...”

ACTIVATE — what it means & how to answer

What it means: “Activate” = wake up what you ALREADY know before you learn more.

Sentence starters: “I already know...” “This reminds me of...” “I want to find out...”

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — what to write

Just your honest first take — there is no wrong answer. Say what you THINK the standard is about and why it might matter to you, your family, or your community. You’ll come back and improve it at the end.

KEY WORDS TO WATCH FOR

Unalienable Rights · Grievances · Declaration of Independence

NOW TRY IT — draft your goal using a starter above

Write a first draft here, then copy your best version onto the front. Aim for: what you’ll DO + how you’ll PROVE it + WHEN.

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — GC.02 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Unalienable Rights	Rights so fundamental they cannot be taken away or given up — in the Declaration, 'Life, Liberty and the pursuit of Happiness.'	derechos inalienables
Grievances	Formal complaints; in the Declaration, the list of specific abuses by King George III used to justify independence.	agravios
Declaration of Independence	The 1776 document, drafted mainly by Thomas Jefferson, that announced the colonies' separation from Britain and stated the principles of government by consent.	Declaración de Independencia

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Unalienable Rights (un-AY-lee-uh-nuh-bul RYTS); Grievances (GREE-vun-sez); Declaration of Independence (dek-luh-RAY-shun).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK · Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 · never seen it	2 · heard it	3 · can use it	4 · can teach it
Unalienable Rights	_____	_____	_____	_____
Grievances	_____	_____	_____	_____
Declaration of Independence	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

QUICK WRITE

Which of these terms do you think will matter MOST for this standard, and why? You'll revisit this at the end.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — GC.02

~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE — three ways to complete each studio**WRITE:** fill in the four boxes below in your own words.**SAY IT:** explain the term aloud to a partner or your teacher, or record a short voice note — say the term, its meaning, and one example.**DIAGRAM:** sketch or map the term in the Sketch Studio on the back of this page.**PRIORITY TERM 1 Unalienable Rights** · ES: derechos inalienables**Word-bank meaning to build on:** Rights so fundamental they cannot be taken away or given up — in the Declaration, 'Life, Liberty and the pursuit of Happiness.'

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Unalienable Rights” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 Declaration of Independence · ES: Declaración de Independencia**Word-bank meaning to build on:** The 1776 document, drafted mainly by Thomas Jefferson, that announced the colonies' separation from Britain and stated the principles of government by consent.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Declaration of Independence” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL · build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write how one leads to or affects another on the lines — or map it in the Sketch Studio on the back.

Activity 2 — Sketch Studio (draw it or say it) — GC.02

SAY IT — pick one way to explain your terms aloud

Explain each priority term to a shoulder partner, then have them explain one back to you.

Or explain a term to your teacher during check-in.

Or record a 20–30 second voice note: say the term, what it means, and one real example.

Or stand and share one term with the class.

DIAGRAM: Unalienable Rights

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

DIAGRAM: Declaration of Independence

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

CONNECT THE TERMS — concept map

Put both terms in the box and draw arrows to show how one leads to, needs, or affects the other. Write a few words on each arrow.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — GC.02 ~20 min

GC.02 — The Declaration of Independence • Lean Student Deck slides 9-15 • direct-teaching slides 11-13

Your learning targets are on this standard's opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Guiding cues	My notes — write your notes here
Key idea of this standard?	
One primary source that supports it?	
One effect on government or rights?	
Key terms →	

DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL · another way in)

Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — GC.02

UDL · CHOOSE HOW YOU CAPTURE IDEAS (same target for everyone)

Keep going with your notes: WRITE on the lines, DRAW or diagram in the box, or do both — your choice. You may also record your notes aloud.

DRAW / DIAGRAM — sketch the idea, a timeline, or how the pieces connect

WRITE — keep taking notes on the lines

Key terms to list

Unalienable Rights · Grievances · Declaration of Independence

Summary — In your own words (2-3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK · one question

The Declaration lists the colonists' natural rights and then a long list of grievances against the king. Why did the writers put these two parts together?

- A. To show that when a government repeatedly violates the people's rights, the people may justly alter or abolish it
- B. To make the document longer and more impressive
- C. To ask King George III to apologize
- D. To describe how to run the new state governments

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ **1**

My 12-15 word headline for this standard

Guided Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.02

These scaffolds support ONLY the Cornell notes — use them to take and process those notes. Optional and easy to set aside; not a separate assignment or a label.

Key vocabulary	What it means
Unalienable Rights	Rights so fundamental they cannot be taken away or given up — in the Declaration, 'Life, Liberty and the pursuit of Happiness.'
Grievances	Formal complaints; in the Declaration, the list of specific abuses by King George III used to justify independence.
Declaration of Independence	The 1776 document, drafted mainly by Thomas Jefferson, that announced the colonies' separation from Britain and stated the principles of government by consent.

Break it into steps:

1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of the declaration of independence was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of the declaration of independence was Unalienable Rights: Rights so fundamental they cannot be taken away or given up — in the Declaration, 'Life, Liberty and the pursuit of Happiness.'

GUIDED NOTE REHEARSAL LAB — practice ONE note, step by step

Build one good note here first, then copy it onto your Cornell page. Name the idea → give one piece of evidence → explain the link → write a short headline.

Step	Rehearse it here
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____
Explain	_____ _____
Headline	_____ _____

TRANSFER CHECK — move one rehearsed idea onto the front notes

Light Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.02

A lighter scaffold for the SAME Cornell notes. Try the notes first; reach for this only if you need it.

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Unalienable Rights	
Grievances	
Declaration of Independence	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below (or in your front notes):

- What three unalienable rights does the Declaration name, and where does government get its 'just powers'?
- Choose one grievance against King George III and explain how it violated the colonists' rights.
- How does the Declaration use natural rights to justify the colonies' break from Britain?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?

Circle the Cornell cue from the front page you still need help with, and tell your teacher so we can go over it.

LIGHT PROCESSING LAB

Answer one guiding question from above in a full sentence, in your own words.

Activity 4 — Close Read — GC.02 ~15 min

Reading type: Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH

On July 4, 1776, the Continental Congress adopted the Declaration of Independence, drafted mainly by Thomas Jefferson. Its most famous lines borrow directly from Locke: all people are 'created equal' and hold 'unalienable Rights' to 'Life, Liberty and the pursuit of Happiness,' and governments derive 'their just powers from the consent of the governed.' The Declaration then lists specific grievances against King George III — dissolving colonial legislatures, taxing without consent, keeping standing armies. The logic is an argument: because government exists to protect rights, a government that repeatedly violates them may justly be altered or abolished. The Declaration announced not just a separation, but a theory of legitimate government.

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Key terms to know first: Unalienable Rights, Grievances. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

Text-dependent questions (answer in the Evidence Lab below or aloud):

1. What three unalienable rights does the Declaration name, and where does government get its 'just powers'?
2. Choose one grievance against King George III and explain how it violated the colonists' rights.
3. How does the Declaration use natural rights to justify the colonies' break from Britain?

RESPONSE CHOICE: answer any question by writing in the Evidence Lab, saying/recording it, or diagramming it.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB

Log evidence from the passage below.

Question / claim	Exact passage evidence	What the evidence shows

In one sentence — the main idea of this reading:

Spaced Retrieval & Reflection — GC.02

SPACED RETRIEVAL — quick recall (no notes)

Pull it up cold to strengthen memory, then check your notes — retrieval is what makes learning stick.

Recall prompt

Your answer (from memory)

One key term or fact from THIS standard

One thing you learned in an EARLIER standard — how does it connect?

One question you can answer now that you could not before

CHECK YOURSELF — look back and score how it went

Got it right? ☐ Yes ☐ Partly ☐ Not yet **Answer it from memory?** ☐ Yes ☐ With a hint ☐ No

How did it feel? ☐ Confident ☐ Getting there ☐ Shaky — I'll revisit

CONNECT IT — spiral back

How does this standard connect to one you studied earlier, or to something in the world today? Write 2-3 sentences.

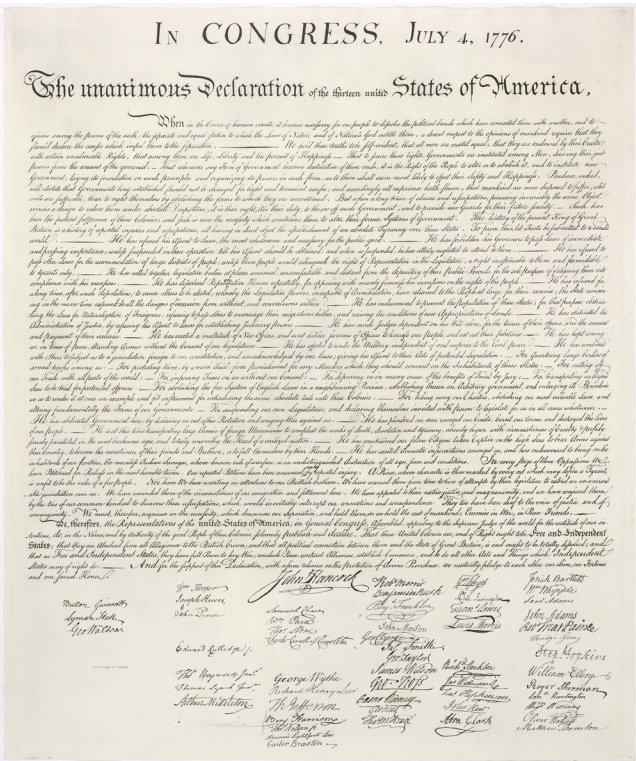
WHERE AM I? — plan your next step

Rate your understanding of this standard (1-4): ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

One thing I will review or ask about before the quiz:

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — GC.02 ~15 min

Primary source (manuscript on parchment) — analyze it with HIPPO. Builds SSP.01-SSP.02.



Declaration of Independence (engrossed copy) • Second Continental Congress; engrossed by Timothy Matlack • 1776

Source: U.S. National Archives • https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:United_States_Declaration_of_Independence.jpg

Public domain — U.S. gov document, 1776

https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:United_States_Declaration_of_Independence.jpg

FIRST LOOK — before you analyze

Jot 3-4 things you notice in the source (details, words, people, dates). No wrong answers.

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

Primary Source Analysis — go deeper — GC.02

SUPPORT OPTION (use if you need it)

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

SOURCE SYNTHESIS — put it together (SSP.03)

In 2–3 sentences: what does this source reveal about this standard, and how do you know? Cite one specific detail from it.

THINK LIKE A HISTORIAN — corroborate or challenge (SSP.03)

Name ONE other source that could CONFIRM this one, and ONE way it could COMPLICATE or CHALLENGE it — or, whose voice is missing here?

SO WHAT? — why this source still matters today

In 1–2 sentences: why does this source still matter for understanding government today?

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit:

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — GC.02 ⌚ ~8 min**RESPONSE CHOICE**

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 1 · item u1-gc02-dok1-1 · pre-field-test]

According to the Declaration, governments derive their just powers from:

- A. the consent of the governed
- B. the king
- C. the wealthiest citizens
- D. the army

[DOK 3 · item u1-gc02-dok3-tc · pre-field-test]

The Declaration lists the colonists' natural rights and then a long list of grievances against the king. Why did the writers put these two parts together?

- A. To show that when a government repeatedly violates the people's rights, the people may justly alter or abolish it
- B. To make the document longer and more impressive
- C. To ask King George III to apologize
- D. To describe how to run the new state governments

STRETCH — think like a test-writer (open to all)

Write your OWN DOK-3 question for this standard, then a one-sentence answer key. Use the supports below — everyone can do this.

HOW TO WRITE A DOK-3 QUESTION (supports)

DOK-3 = strategic thinking: the reader must analyze, compare, evaluate, or justify using evidence — and there should be more than one defensible answer (not a fact you can just look up).

Sentence starters: “Why did _____ lead to _____?” · “Which mattered more — _____ or _____ — and why?” · “What is the BEST evidence that _____?” · “Evaluate whether _____.” · “Defend or challenge: _____.”

Frame: [Analyze / Evaluate / Justify] + [something from THIS standard] + “using evidence.”

Quick check: does my question make the reader THINK and use evidence? If yes, it's DOK-3.

NOW WRITE YOUR DOK-3 QUESTION HERE

YOUR ANSWER KEY — one clear, defensible sentence

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — GC.02 ~15 min

BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER (before you write) — How and why did the Founders build a limited constitutional republic?

Plan your argument here, then use it to write your claim, evidence, and reasoning below.

Plan your argument

Your quick notes (from this standard)

My claim (answer the prompt)

Evidence 1 (a source or fact)

Reasoning (why it proves the claim)

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Was the Declaration of Independence mainly a list of complaints, or an argument about the purpose of government? Defend your claim with two quotations from the text.

Part

Write here

Claim

Evidence (two specifics)

Reasoning

Constructed Response — self-grade & supports — GC.02

SELF-GRADE — score your own CER against the rubric below

Reread your response, then circle the level that best fits each part. Being honest here is how you level up.

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
4 — Strong	Precise, defensible	2+ accurate, specific	Explains HOW evidence proves the claim
3 — Proficient	Clear	2 accurate	Explains the link
2 — Developing	General	1 accurate	Partial link
1 — Beginning	Unclear / missing	Missing / inaccurate	No reasoning

MY SCORE

Claim: ____ / 4 Evidence: ____ / 4 Reasoning: ____ / 4 TOTAL: ____ / 12

SUPPORTS — sentence frames (use if you need them)

Claim: “_____ because _____.”

Evidence: “One example is _____ (from _____). Another is _____.”

Reasoning: “This proves my claim because _____, which shows _____.”

REVISE — make your lowest-scoring part stronger

Pick the part you scored lowest and rewrite it here — better:

Standard GC.03 — The Articles of Confederation

TN Academic Standard GC.03: Identify the strengths and weaknesses of the Articles of Confederation. (H)

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can identify the strengths and weaknesses of the Articles of Confederation..

Lenses for this standard: History (H)

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Every student works this standard at the same rigor: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER. Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page. Supports for each step are on the back of this page.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it? (Need help? See the back of this page.)

HOOK — think before you dig in

Imagine a national government that can declare war but can't collect a dime to pay for it. That was America under the Articles. What went wrong?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — before you dig in (you'll revisit this at the end)

In your own words: what do you think this standard is about, and why might it matter to you or your community? Write 2-3 sentences.

Getting Started — supports for this page — GC.03

WHAT “CORE PATH” MEANS

Everyone learns the same standard at the same level. “Support options” are just extra ways in — sentence starters, an example, a partner, or recording your answer. They help you reach the bar; they never lower it.

SET YOUR GOAL — how to write a strong one

Example goal: “By the end of this standard I can explain ___ and prove it by scoring 80%+ on the quiz.”

How to build it: name what you’ll DO, then how you’ll PROVE it, then WHEN.

Sentence starters: “I want to be able to...” “I’ll show it by...” “By the end of this standard...”

HOOK — sentence starters

“I think the big question is...” “This connects to...” “I wonder why...” “At first I believe...”

ACTIVATE — what it means & how to answer

What it means: “Activate” = wake up what you ALREADY know before you learn more.

Sentence starters: “I already know...” “This reminds me of...” “I want to find out...”

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — what to write

Just your honest first take — there is no wrong answer. Say what you THINK the standard is about and why it might matter to you, your family, or your community. You’ll come back and improve it at the end.

KEY WORDS TO WATCH FOR

Confederation · Articles of Confederation · Shays's Rebellion

NOW TRY IT — draft your goal using a starter above

Write a first draft here, then copy your best version onto the front. Aim for: what you’ll DO + how you’ll PROVE it + WHEN.

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — GC.03 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Confederation	A loose union of independent states that keep most of their power, giving only limited authority to a weak central government.	confederación
Articles of Confederation	The first national constitution of the United States (1781-1789); it created a weak central government that could not tax or regulate trade.	Artículos de la Confederación
Shays's Rebellion	A 1786-1787 uprising of Massachusetts farmers that the weak national government could not put down — exposing the failures of the Articles and pushing leaders toward a new constitution.	Rebelión de Shays

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Confederation (kon-fed-uh-RAY-shun); Articles of Confederation (AR-tih-kulz); Shays's Rebellion (SHAYZ ree-BEL-yun).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK · Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 · never seen it	2 · heard it	3 · can use it	4 · can teach it
Confederation	_____	_____	_____	_____
Articles of Confederation	_____	_____	_____	_____
Shays's Rebellion	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

QUICK WRITE

Which of these terms do you think will matter MOST for this standard, and why? You'll revisit this at the end.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — GC.03

~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE — three ways to complete each studio**WRITE:** fill in the four boxes below in your own words.**SAY IT:** explain the term aloud to a partner or your teacher, or record a short voice note — say the term, its meaning, and one example.**DIAGRAM:** sketch or map the term in the Sketch Studio on the back of this page.**PRIORITY TERM 1 Confederation** · ES: confederación**Word-bank meaning to build on:** A loose union of independent states that keep most of their power, giving only limited authority to a weak central government.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Confederation” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 Articles of Confederation · ES: Artículos de la Confederación**Word-bank meaning to build on:** The first national constitution of the United States (1781–1789); it created a weak central government that could not tax or regulate trade.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Articles of Confederation” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL · build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write how one leads to or affects another on the lines — or map it in the Sketch Studio on the back.

Activity 2 — Sketch Studio (draw it or say it) — GC.03

SAY IT — pick one way to explain your terms aloud

Explain each priority term to a shoulder partner, then have them explain one back to you.

Or explain a term to your teacher during check-in.

Or record a 20–30 second voice note: say the term, what it means, and one real example.

Or stand and share one term with the class.

DIAGRAM: Confederation

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

DIAGRAM: Articles of Confederation

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

CONNECT THE TERMS — concept map

Put both terms in the box and draw arrows to show how one leads to, needs, or affects the other. Write a few words on each arrow.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — GC.03 ~20 min

GC.03 — The Articles of Confederation • Lean Student Deck slides 16-22 • direct-teaching slides 18-20

Your learning targets are on this standard's opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Guiding cues	My notes — write your notes here
Key idea of this standard?	
One primary source that supports it?	
One effect on government or rights?	
Key terms →	

DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL · another way in)

Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — GC.03

UDL · CHOOSE HOW YOU CAPTURE IDEAS (same target for everyone)

Keep going with your notes: WRITE on the lines, DRAW or diagram in the box, or do both — your choice. You may also record your notes aloud.

DRAW / DIAGRAM — sketch the idea, a timeline, or how the pieces connect

WRITE — keep taking notes on the lines

Key terms to list

Confederation · Articles of Confederation · Shays's Rebellion

Summary — In your own words (2-3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK · one question

Under the Articles of Confederation, which power did the national government LACK that caused serious problems?

- A. The power to declare war
- B. The power to make treaties
- C. The power to run a post office
- D. The power to tax the states and citizens directly

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ **1**

My 12-15 word headline for this standard

Guided Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.03

These scaffolds support ONLY the Cornell notes — use them to take and process those notes. Optional and easy to set aside; not a separate assignment or a label.

Key vocabulary	What it means
Confederation	A loose union of independent states that keep most of their power, giving only limited authority to a weak central government.
Articles of Confederation	The first national constitution of the United States (1781–1789); it created a weak central government that could not tax or regulate trade.
Shays's Rebellion	A 1786–1787 uprising of Massachusetts farmers that the weak national government could not put down — exposing the failures of the Articles and pushing leaders toward a new constitution.

Break it into steps:

1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of the articles of confederation was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of the articles of confederation was Confederation: A loose union of independent states that keep most of their power, giving only limited authority to a weak central government.

GUIDED NOTE REHEARSAL LAB — practice ONE note, step by step

Build one good note here first, then copy it onto your Cornell page. Name the idea → give one piece of evidence → explain the link → write a short headline.

Step	Rehearse it here
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____
Explain	_____ _____
Headline	_____ _____

TRANSFER CHECK — move one rehearsed idea onto the front notes

Light Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.03

A lighter scaffold for the SAME Cornell notes. Try the notes first; reach for this only if you need it.

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Confederation	
Articles of Confederation	
Shays's Rebellion	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below (or in your front notes):

- According to Article II, how much power did each state keep under the Articles of Confederation?
- Name two powers the national government lacked under the Articles, and explain one problem each caused.
- How did Shays's Rebellion reveal the weaknesses of the Articles?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?

Circle the Cornell cue from the front page you still need help with, and tell your teacher so we can go over it.

LIGHT PROCESSING LAB

Answer one guiding question from above in a full sentence, in your own words.

Activity 4 — Close Read — GC.03 ~15 min

Reading type: Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH

Winning independence required a national government, but Americans feared creating another all-powerful ruler. So the Articles of Confederation (ratified 1781) kept the states 'sovereign' and gave Congress only limited powers. Congress could declare war, make treaties, and run a post office — but it could NOT tax, could NOT regulate trade between states, and needed nine of thirteen states to pass major laws and all thirteen to amend the Articles. The result was a government too weak to pay its debts or keep order. When Shays's Rebellion broke out in Massachusetts in 1786, the national government could not raise an army to stop it. Leaders like Washington and Madison concluded the Articles had to be replaced.

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Key terms to know first: Confederation, Articles of Confederation. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

Text-dependent questions (answer in the Evidence Lab below or aloud):

1. According to Article II, how much power did each state keep under the Articles of Confederation?
2. Name two powers the national government lacked under the Articles, and explain one problem each caused.
3. How did Shays's Rebellion reveal the weaknesses of the Articles?

RESPONSE CHOICE: answer any question by writing in the Evidence Lab, saying/recording it, or diagramming it.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB

Log evidence from the passage below.

Question / claim	Exact passage evidence	What the evidence shows

In one sentence — the main idea of this reading:

Spaced Retrieval & Reflection — GC.03

SPACED RETRIEVAL — quick recall (no notes)

Pull it up cold to strengthen memory, then check your notes — retrieval is what makes learning stick.

Recall prompt

Your answer (from memory)

One key term or fact from THIS standard

One thing you learned in an EARLIER standard — how does it connect?

One question you can answer now that you could not before

CHECK YOURSELF — look back and score how it went

Got it right? ☐ Yes ☐ Partly ☐ Not yet **Answer it from memory?** ☐ Yes ☐ With a hint ☐ No

How did it feel? ☐ Confident ☐ Getting there ☐ Shaky — I'll revisit

CONNECT IT — spiral back

How does this standard connect to one you studied earlier, or to something in the world today? Write 2-3 sentences.

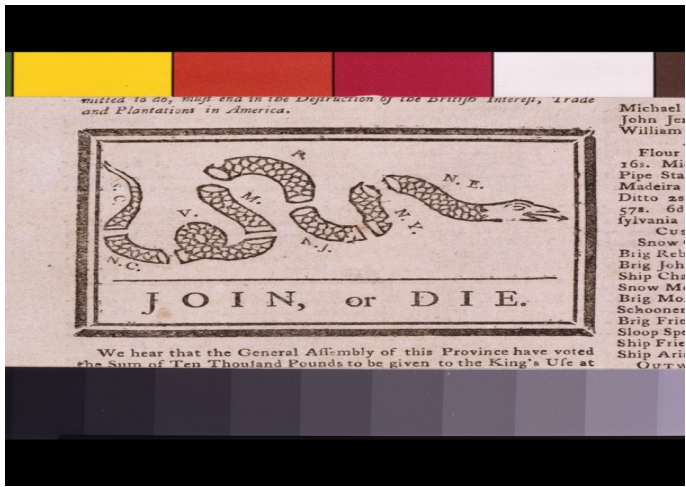
WHERE AM I? — plan your next step

Rate your understanding of this standard (1-4): ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

One thing I will review or ask about before the quiz:

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — GC.03 ⌚ ~15 min

Primary source (woodcut political cartoon) — analyze it with HIPPO. Builds SSP.01–SSP.02.



Join, or Die · Benjamin Franklin · 1754

Source: Library of Congress, Prints & Photographs Division · <https://www.loc.gov/item/2002695523/> Public domain — published 1754 (pre-1929) <https://www.loc.gov/item/2002695523/>

FIRST LOOK — before you analyze

Jot 3–4 things you notice in the source (details, words, people, dates). No wrong answers.

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

Primary Source Analysis — go deeper — GC.03

SUPPORT OPTION (use if you need it)

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

SOURCE SYNTHESIS — put it together (SSP.03)

In 2–3 sentences: what does this source reveal about this standard, and how do you know? Cite one specific detail from it.

THINK LIKE A HISTORIAN — corroborate or challenge (SSP.03)

Name ONE other source that could CONFIRM this one, and ONE way it could COMPLICATE or CHALLENGE it — or, whose voice is missing here?

SO WHAT? — why this source still matters today

In 1–2 sentences: why does this source still matter for understanding government today?

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit:

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — GC.03 ⌚ ~8 min**RESPONSE CHOICE**

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 1 • item u1-gc03-dok1-1 • pre-field-test]

The Articles of Confederation created a national government that was:

- A. too weak to tax or regulate trade
- B. a monarchy
- C. stronger than today's federal government
- D. controlled by the president

[DOK 2 • item u1-gc03-dok2-tc • pre-field-test]

Under the Articles of Confederation, which power did the national government LACK that caused serious problems?

- A. The power to declare war
- B. The power to make treaties
- C. The power to run a post office
- D. The power to tax the states and citizens directly

STRETCH — think like a test-writer (open to all)

Write your OWN DOK-3 question for this standard, then a one-sentence answer key. Use the supports below — everyone can do this.

HOW TO WRITE A DOK-3 QUESTION (supports)

DOK-3 = strategic thinking: the reader must analyze, compare, evaluate, or justify using evidence — and there should be more than one defensible answer (not a fact you can just look up).

Sentence starters: “Why did _____ lead to _____?” • “Which mattered more — _____ or _____ — and why?” • “What is the BEST evidence that _____?” • “Evaluate whether _____.” • “Defend or challenge: _____.”

Frame: [Analyze / Evaluate / Justify] + [something from THIS standard] + “using evidence.”

Quick check: does my question make the reader THINK and use evidence? If yes, it's DOK-3.

NOW WRITE YOUR DOK-3 QUESTION HERE

YOUR ANSWER KEY — one clear, defensible sentence

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — GC.03 ~15 min

BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER (before you write) — How and why did the Founders build a limited constitutional republic?

Plan your argument here, then use it to write your claim, evidence, and reasoning below.

Plan your argument

Your quick notes (from this standard)

My claim (answer the prompt)

Evidence 1 (a source or fact)

Reasoning (why it proves the claim)

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Was the greatest weakness of the Articles the lack of taxing power, the lack of a strong executive, or the difficulty of amendment? Defend your claim with evidence.

Part

Write here

Claim

Evidence (two specifics)

Reasoning

Constructed Response — self-grade & supports — GC.03

SELF-GRADE — score your own CER against the rubric below

Reread your response, then circle the level that best fits each part. Being honest here is how you level up.

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
4 — Strong	Precise, defensible	2+ accurate, specific	Explains HOW evidence proves the claim
3 — Proficient	Clear	2 accurate	Explains the link
2 — Developing	General	1 accurate	Partial link
1 — Beginning	Unclear / missing	Missing / inaccurate	No reasoning

MY SCORE

Claim: ____ / 4 Evidence: ____ / 4 Reasoning: ____ / 4 TOTAL: ____ / 12

SUPPORTS — sentence frames (use if you need them)

Claim: “_____ because _____.”

Evidence: “One example is _____ (from _____). Another is _____.”

Reasoning: “This proves my claim because _____, which shows _____.”

REVISE — make your lowest-scoring part stronger

Pick the part you scored lowest and rewrite it here — better:

Standard GC.04 — The Constitutional Convention & Ratification

TN Academic Standard GC.04: Discuss the Constitutional Convention of 1787, including the Great Compromise and the ensuing debate over ratification between the Federalists and Anti-Federalists. (H)

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can discuss the Constitutional Convention of 1787, including the Great Compromise and the ensuing debate over ratification between the Federalists and Anti-Federalists..

Lenses for this standard: History (H)

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Every student works this standard at the same rigor: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER. Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page. Supports for each step are on the back of this page.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it? (Need help? See the back of this page.)

HOOK — think before you dig in

Two plans, thirteen stubborn states, one hot Philadelphia summer. How did the Framers turn a deadlock into a Constitution?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — before you dig in (you'll revisit this at the end)

In your own words: what do you think this standard is about, and why might it matter to you or your community? Write 2-3 sentences.

Getting Started — supports for this page — GC.04

WHAT “CORE PATH” MEANS

Everyone learns the same standard at the same level. “Support options” are just extra ways in — sentence starters, an example, a partner, or recording your answer. They help you reach the bar; they never lower it.

SET YOUR GOAL — how to write a strong one

Example goal: “By the end of this standard I can explain ___ and prove it by scoring 80%+ on the quiz.”

How to build it: name what you’ll DO, then how you’ll PROVE it, then WHEN.

Sentence starters: “I want to be able to...” “I’ll show it by...” “By the end of this standard...”

HOOK — sentence starters

“I think the big question is...” “This connects to...” “I wonder why...” “At first I believe...”

ACTIVATE — what it means & how to answer

What it means: “Activate” = wake up what you ALREADY know before you learn more.

Sentence starters: “I already know...” “This reminds me of...” “I want to find out...”

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — what to write

Just your honest first take — there is no wrong answer. Say what you THINK the standard is about and why it might matter to you, your family, or your community. You’ll come back and improve it at the end.

KEY WORDS TO WATCH FOR

Great Compromise · Federalists · Anti-Federalists

NOW TRY IT — draft your goal using a starter above

Write a first draft here, then copy your best version onto the front. Aim for: what you’ll DO + how you’ll PROVE it + WHEN.

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — GC.04 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Great Compromise	The 1787 agreement creating a two-house Congress: a House based on state population and a Senate with equal representation (two per state) — settling the fight between large and small states.	Gran Compromiso
Federalists	Supporters of ratifying the Constitution who favored a stronger national government; their arguments appear in the Federalist Papers.	federalistas
Anti-Federalists	Opponents of ratifying the Constitution as written, who feared a too-powerful central government and demanded a bill of rights to protect individual liberty.	antifederalistas

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Great Compromise (GRAYT KOM-pruh-myz); Federalists (FED-uh-rul-ists); Anti-Federalists (AN-tee-FED-uh-rul-ists).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK • Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 • never seen it	2 • heard it	3 • can use it	4 • can teach it
Great Compromise	_____	_____	_____	_____
Federalists	_____	_____	_____	_____
Anti-Federalists	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

QUICK WRITE

Which of these terms do you think will matter MOST for this standard, and why? You'll revisit this at the end.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — GC.04

~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE — three ways to complete each studio**WRITE:** fill in the four boxes below in your own words.**SAY IT:** explain the term aloud to a partner or your teacher, or record a short voice note — say the term, its meaning, and one example.**DIAGRAM:** sketch or map the term in the Sketch Studio on the back of this page.**PRIORITY TERM 1 Great Compromise** · ES: Gran Compromiso**Word-bank meaning to build on:** The 1787 agreement creating a two-house Congress: a House based on state population and a Senate with equal representation (two per state) — settling the fight between large and small states.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Great Compromise” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 Federalists · ES: federalistas**Word-bank meaning to build on:** Supporters of ratifying the Constitution who favored a stronger national government; their arguments appear in the Federalist Papers.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Federalists” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL • build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write how one leads to or affects another on the lines — or map it in the Sketch Studio on the back.

Activity 2 — Sketch Studio (draw it or say it) — GC.04

SAY IT — pick one way to explain your terms aloud

Explain each priority term to a shoulder partner, then have them explain one back to you.

Or explain a term to your teacher during check-in.

Or record a 20–30 second voice note: say the term, what it means, and one real example.

Or stand and share one term with the class.

DIAGRAM: Great Compromise

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

DIAGRAM: Federalists

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

CONNECT THE TERMS — concept map

Put both terms in the box and draw arrows to show how one leads to, needs, or affects the other. Write a few words on each arrow.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — GC.04 ~20 min

GC.04 — The Constitutional Convention & Ratification • Lean Student Deck slides 23–29 • direct-teaching slides 25–27

Your learning targets are on this standard's opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Guiding cues	My notes — write your notes here
Key idea of this standard?	
One primary source that supports it?	
One effect on government or rights?	
Key terms →	

DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL · another way in)

Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — GC.04

UDL · CHOOSE HOW YOU CAPTURE IDEAS (same target for everyone)

Keep going with your notes: WRITE on the lines, DRAW or diagram in the box, or do both — your choice. You may also record your notes aloud.

DRAW / DIAGRAM — sketch the idea, a timeline, or how the pieces connect

WRITE — keep taking notes on the lines

Key terms to list

Great Compromise · Federalists · Anti-Federalists

Summary — In your own words (2-3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK · one question

The Great Compromise settled which major disagreement at the Constitutional Convention?

- A. Whether to have a president or a king
- B. How states should be represented in Congress — by population or equally
- C. Whether to keep the Articles of Confederation
- D. Whether to allow political parties

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ **1**

My 12-15 word headline for this standard

Guided Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.04

These scaffolds support ONLY the Cornell notes — use them to take and process those notes. Optional and easy to set aside; not a separate assignment or a label.

Key vocabulary	What it means
Great Compromise	The 1787 agreement creating a two-house Congress: a House based on state population and a Senate with equal representation (two per state) — settling the fight between large and small states.
Federalists	Supporters of ratifying the Constitution who favored a stronger national government; their arguments appear in the Federalist Papers.
Anti-Federalists	Opponents of ratifying the Constitution as written, who feared a too-powerful central government and demanded a bill of rights to protect individual liberty.

Break it into steps:

1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of the constitutional convention & ratification was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of the constitutional convention & ratification was Great Compromise: The 1787 agreement creating a two-house Congress: a House based on state population and a Senate with equal representation (two per state) — settling the fight between large and small states.

GUIDED NOTE REHEARSAL LAB — practice ONE note, step by step

Build one good note here first, then copy it onto your Cornell page. Name the idea → give one piece of evidence → explain the link → write a short headline.

Step	Rehearse it here
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____
Explain	_____ _____
Headline	_____ _____

TRANSFER CHECK — move one rehearsed idea onto the front notes

Light Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.04

A lighter scaffold for the SAME Cornell notes. Try the notes first; reach for this only if you need it.

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Great Compromise	
Federalists	
Anti-Federalists	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below (or in your front notes):

- How did the Great Compromise resolve the conflict between large and small states?
- In Federalist No. 10, what problem does Madison say a large republic can control better than a small one?
- What was the Anti-Federalists' main fear, and what did they demand before ratifying?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?

Circle the Cornell cue from the front page you still need help with, and tell your teacher so we can go over it.

LIGHT PROCESSING LAB

Answer one guiding question from above in a full sentence, in your own words.

Activity 4 — Close Read — GC.04 ~15 min

Reading type: Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH

In 1787, delegates met in Philadelphia — officially to fix the Articles, but they wrote an entirely new Constitution. The hardest fight was representation. Large states backed the Virginia Plan (seats by population); small states backed the New Jersey Plan (equal seats). The Great Compromise split the difference: a House of Representatives based on population and a Senate with two senators per state. The Three-Fifths Compromise, counting enslaved people as three-fifths of a person for representation and taxation, exposed the deep contradiction of slavery in a document about liberty. Once signed, the Constitution faced a fierce ratification debate. Federalists (Madison, Hamilton, Jay, writing as 'Publius' in the Federalist Papers) argued for a stronger union; Anti-Federalists (like 'Brutus') warned of a distant, too-powerful government and demanded a bill of rights.

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Key terms to know first: Great Compromise, Federalists. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

Text-dependent questions (answer in the Evidence Lab below or aloud):

1. How did the Great Compromise resolve the conflict between large and small states?
2. In Federalist No. 10, what problem does Madison say a large republic can control better than a small one?
3. What was the Anti-Federalists' main fear, and what did they demand before ratifying?

RESPONSE CHOICE: answer any question by writing in the Evidence Lab, saying/recording it, or diagramming it.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB

Log evidence from the passage below.

Question / claim	Exact passage evidence	What the evidence shows

In one sentence — the main idea of this reading:

Spaced Retrieval & Reflection — GC.04

SPACED RETRIEVAL — quick recall (no notes)

Pull it up cold to strengthen memory, then check your notes — retrieval is what makes learning stick.

Recall prompt

Your answer (from memory)

One key term or fact from THIS standard

One thing you learned in an EARLIER standard — how does it connect?

One question you can answer now that you could not before

CHECK YOURSELF — look back and score how it went

Got it right? ☐ Yes ☐ Partly ☐ Not yet Answer it from memory? ☐ Yes ☐ With a hint ☐ No

How did it feel? ☐ Confident ☐ Getting there ☐ Shaky — I'll revisit

CONNECT IT — spiral back

How does this standard connect to one you studied earlier, or to something in the world today? Write 2-3 sentences.

WHERE AM I? — plan your next step

Rate your understanding of this standard (1-4): ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

One thing I will review or ask about before the quiz:

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — GC.04 ~15 min

Document (text primary source — analyze with HIPPO). Builds SSP.01–SSP.02.

FEDERALIST NO. 10

“The latent causes of faction are thus sown in the nature of man... The regulation of these various and interfering interests forms the principal task of modern legislation.”

Source: James Madison (Publius), 1787. Congress.gov / Library of Congress. Public domain.
<https://guides.loc.gov/federalist-papers/text-1-10>

FIRST LOOK — before you analyze

Jot 3–4 things you notice in the source (details, words, people, dates). No wrong answers.

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

Primary Source Analysis — go deeper — GC.04

SUPPORT OPTION (use if you need it)

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

SOURCE SYNTHESIS — put it together (SSP.03)

In 2–3 sentences: what does this source reveal about this standard, and how do you know? Cite one specific detail from it.

THINK LIKE A HISTORIAN — corroborate or challenge (SSP.03)

Name ONE other source that could CONFIRM this one, and ONE way it could COMPLICATE or CHALLENGE it — or, whose voice is missing here?

SO WHAT? — why this source still matters today

In 1–2 sentences: why does this source still matter for understanding government today?

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit:

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — GC.04 ⌚ ~8 min**RESPONSE CHOICE**

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 1 • item u1-gc04-dok1-1 • pre-field-test]

The Federalist Papers were written to:

- A. persuade people to ratify the Constitution
- B. declare independence
- C. repeal the Bill of Rights
- D. end the Convention early

[DOK 3 • item u1-gc04-dok3-tc • pre-field-test]

The Great Compromise settled which major disagreement at the Constitutional Convention?

- A. Whether to have a president or a king
- B. How states should be represented in Congress — by population or equally
- C. Whether to keep the Articles of Confederation
- D. Whether to allow political parties

STRETCH — think like a test-writer (open to all)

Write your OWN DOK-3 question for this standard, then a one-sentence answer key. Use the supports below — everyone can do this.

HOW TO WRITE A DOK-3 QUESTION (supports)

DOK-3 = strategic thinking: the reader must analyze, compare, evaluate, or justify using evidence — and there should be more than one defensible answer (not a fact you can just look up).

Sentence starters: “Why did _____ lead to _____?” • “Which mattered more — _____ or _____ — and why?” • “What is the BEST evidence that _____?” • “Evaluate whether _____.” • “Defend or challenge: _____.”

Frame: [Analyze / Evaluate / Justify] + [something from THIS standard] + “using evidence.”

Quick check: does my question make the reader THINK and use evidence? If yes, it's DOK-3.

NOW WRITE YOUR DOK-3 QUESTION HERE

YOUR ANSWER KEY — one clear, defensible sentence

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — GC.04 ~15 min

BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER (before you write) — How and why did the Founders build a limited constitutional republic?

Plan your argument here, then use it to write your claim, evidence, and reasoning below.

Plan your argument

Your quick notes (from this standard)

My claim (answer the prompt)

Evidence 1 (a source or fact)

Reasoning (why it proves the claim)

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: In the ratification debate, whose warning has aged better — the Federalists' case for a strong union, or the Anti-Federalists' fear of centralized power? Use one quote from each side.

Part

Write here

Claim

Evidence (two specifics)

Reasoning

Constructed Response — self-grade & supports — GC.04

SELF-GRADE — score your own CER against the rubric below

Reread your response, then circle the level that best fits each part. Being honest here is how you level up.

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
4 — Strong	Precise, defensible	2+ accurate, specific	Explains HOW evidence proves the claim
3 — Proficient	Clear	2 accurate	Explains the link
2 — Developing	General	1 accurate	Partial link
1 — Beginning	Unclear / missing	Missing / inaccurate	No reasoning

MY SCORE

Claim: ____ / 4 Evidence: ____ / 4 Reasoning: ____ / 4 TOTAL: ____ / 12

SUPPORTS — sentence frames (use if you need them)

Claim: “_____ because _____.”

Evidence: “One example is _____ (from _____). Another is _____.”

Reasoning: “This proves my claim because _____, which shows _____.”

REVISE — make your lowest-scoring part stronger

Pick the part you scored lowest and rewrite it here — better:

Standard GC.05 — The Preamble: Purposes of Government

TN Academic Standard GC.05: Describe the purposes and functions of government as outlined in the Preamble of the Constitution.

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can describe the purposes and functions of government as outlined in the Preamble of the Constitution..

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Every student works this standard at the same rigor: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER. Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page. Supports for each step are on the back of this page.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it? (Need help? See the back of this page.)

HOOK — think before you dig in

Six goals, one sentence, and it starts with three world-changing words: 'We the People.' What did the Framers promise?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — before you dig in (you'll revisit this at the end)

In your own words: what do you think this standard is about, and why might it matter to you or your community? Write 2-3 sentences.

Getting Started — supports for this page — GC.05

WHAT “CORE PATH” MEANS

Everyone learns the same standard at the same level. “Support options” are just extra ways in — sentence starters, an example, a partner, or recording your answer. They help you reach the bar; they never lower it.

SET YOUR GOAL — how to write a strong one

Example goal: “By the end of this standard I can explain ___ and prove it by scoring 80%+ on the quiz.”

How to build it: name what you’ll DO, then how you’ll PROVE it, then WHEN.

Sentence starters: “I want to be able to...” “I’ll show it by...” “By the end of this standard...”

HOOK — sentence starters

“I think the big question is...” “This connects to...” “I wonder why...” “At first I believe...”

ACTIVATE — what it means & how to answer

What it means: “Activate” = wake up what you ALREADY know before you learn more.

Sentence starters: “I already know...” “This reminds me of...” “I want to find out...”

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — what to write

Just your honest first take — there is no wrong answer. Say what you THINK the standard is about and why it might matter to you, your family, or your community. You’ll come back and improve it at the end.

KEY WORDS TO WATCH FOR

Preamble · Popular Sovereignty · General Welfare

NOW TRY IT — draft your goal using a starter above

Write a first draft here, then copy your best version onto the front. Aim for: what you’ll DO + how you’ll PROVE it + WHEN.

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — GC.05 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Preamble	The introduction to the Constitution that states the document's purposes, beginning 'We the People.'	preámbulo
Popular Sovereignty	The principle that government's authority comes from the people — expressed in the Preamble's opening words, 'We the People.'	soberanía popular
General Welfare	The well-being of the whole community; one of the Preamble's stated purposes of government ('promote the general Welfare').	bienestar general

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Preamble (PREE-am-bul); Popular Sovereignty (POP-yuh-lur SOV-rin-tee); General Welfare (JEN-uh-rul WEL-fair).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK · Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 · never seen it	2 · heard it	3 · can use it	4 · can teach it
Preamble				
Popular Sovereignty				
General Welfare				

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

QUICK WRITE

Which of these terms do you think will matter MOST for this standard, and why? You'll revisit this at the end.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — GC.05

~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE — three ways to complete each studio**WRITE:** fill in the four boxes below in your own words.**SAY IT:** explain the term aloud to a partner or your teacher, or record a short voice note — say the term, its meaning, and one example.**DIAGRAM:** sketch or map the term in the Sketch Studio on the back of this page.**PRIORITY TERM 1 Preamble** · ES: preámbulo**Word-bank meaning to build on:** The introduction to the Constitution that states the document's purposes, beginning 'We the People.'

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Preamble” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 Popular Sovereignty · ES: soberanía popular**Word-bank meaning to build on:** The principle that government's authority comes from the people — expressed in the Preamble's opening words, 'We the People.'

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Popular Sovereignty” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL · build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write how one leads to or affects another on the lines — or map it in the Sketch Studio on the back.

Activity 2 — Sketch Studio (draw it or say it) — GC.05

SAY IT — pick one way to explain your terms aloud

Explain each priority term to a shoulder partner, then have them explain one back to you.

Or explain a term to your teacher during check-in.

Or record a 20–30 second voice note: say the term, what it means, and one real example.

Or stand and share one term with the class.

DIAGRAM: Preamble

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

DIAGRAM: Popular Sovereignty

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

CONNECT THE TERMS — concept map

Put both terms in the box and draw arrows to show how one leads to, needs, or affects the other. Write a few words on each arrow.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — GC.05 ⌚ ~20 min

GC.05 — The Preamble: Purposes of Government • Lean Student Deck slides 30–36 • direct-teaching slides 32–34

Your learning targets are on this standard’s opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Guiding cues	My notes — write your notes here
Key idea of this standard?	
One primary source that supports it?	
One effect on government or rights?	
Key terms →	

DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL · another way in)
Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — GC.05

UDL · CHOOSE HOW YOU CAPTURE IDEAS (same target for everyone)

Keep going with your notes: WRITE on the lines, DRAW or diagram in the box, or do both — your choice. You may also record your notes aloud.

DRAW / DIAGRAM — sketch the idea, a timeline, or how the pieces connect

WRITE — keep taking notes on the lines

Key terms to list

Preamble · Popular Sovereignty · General Welfare

Summary — In your own words (2-3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK · one question

The Preamble begins with the words 'We the People.' Which principle of government does this phrase express?

- A. Judicial review
- B. Separation of powers
- C. Popular sovereignty — government power comes from the people
- D. Federalism

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ **1**

My 12-15 word headline for this standard

Guided Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.05

These scaffolds support ONLY the Cornell notes — use them to take and process those notes. Optional and easy to set aside; not a separate assignment or a label.

Key vocabulary	What it means
Preamble	The introduction to the Constitution that states the document's purposes, beginning 'We the People.'
Popular Sovereignty	The principle that government's authority comes from the people — expressed in the Preamble's opening words, 'We the People.'
General Welfare	The well-being of the whole community; one of the Preamble's stated purposes of government ('promote the general Welfare').

Break it into steps:

1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of the preamble was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of the preamble was Preamble: The introduction to the Constitution that states the document's purposes, beginning 'We the People.'

GUIDED NOTE REHEARSAL LAB — practice ONE note, step by step

Build one good note here first, then copy it onto your Cornell page. Name the idea → give one piece of evidence → explain the link → write a short headline.

Step	Rehearse it here
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____
Explain	_____ _____
Headline	_____ _____

TRANSFER CHECK — move one rehearsed idea onto the front notes

Light Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.05

A lighter scaffold for the SAME Cornell notes. Try the notes first; reach for this only if you need it.

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Preamble	
Popular Sovereignty	
General Welfare	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below (or in your front notes):

- What do the first three words of the Preamble tell us about where government power comes from?
- List three of the six purposes of government named in the Preamble.
- How does the phrase 'to ourselves and our Posterity' show the Framers were thinking beyond their own time?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?

Circle the Cornell cue from the front page you still need help with, and tell your teacher so we can go over it.

LIGHT PROCESSING LAB

Answer one guiding question from above in a full sentence, in your own words.

Activity 4 — Close Read — GC.05 ~15 min

Reading type: Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH

Before a single power is granted, the Constitution states WHY it exists. The Preamble — 'We the People of the United States' — opens by declaring popular sovereignty: the government's authority comes from the people. It then lists six purposes: to form a more perfect Union, establish Justice, insure domestic Tranquility, provide for the common defence, promote the general Welfare, and secure the Blessings of Liberty for ourselves and future generations ('our Posterity'). The Preamble grants no powers by itself, but it is a mission statement: every power in the articles that follow is meant to serve these ends.

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Key terms to know first: Preamble, Popular Sovereignty. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

Text-dependent questions (answer in the Evidence Lab below or aloud):

1. What do the first three words of the Preamble tell us about where government power comes from?
2. List three of the six purposes of government named in the Preamble.
3. How does the phrase 'to ourselves and our Posterity' show the Framers were thinking beyond their own time?

RESPONSE CHOICE: answer any question by writing in the Evidence Lab, saying/recording it, or diagramming it.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB

Log evidence from the passage below.

Question / claim	Exact passage evidence	What the evidence shows

In one sentence — the main idea of this reading:

Spaced Retrieval & Reflection — GC.05

SPACED RETRIEVAL — quick recall (no notes)

Pull it up cold to strengthen memory, then check your notes — retrieval is what makes learning stick.

Recall prompt	Your answer (from memory)
One key term or fact from THIS standard	
One thing you learned in an EARLIER standard — how does it connect?	
One question you can answer now that you could not before	

CHECK YOURSELF — look back and score how it went

Got it right? ☐ Yes ☐ Partly ☐ Not yet **Answer it from memory?** ☐ Yes ☐ With a hint ☐ No

How did it feel? ☐ Confident ☐ Getting there ☐ Shaky — I'll revisit

CONNECT IT — spiral back

How does this standard connect to one you studied earlier, or to something in the world today? Write 2-3 sentences.

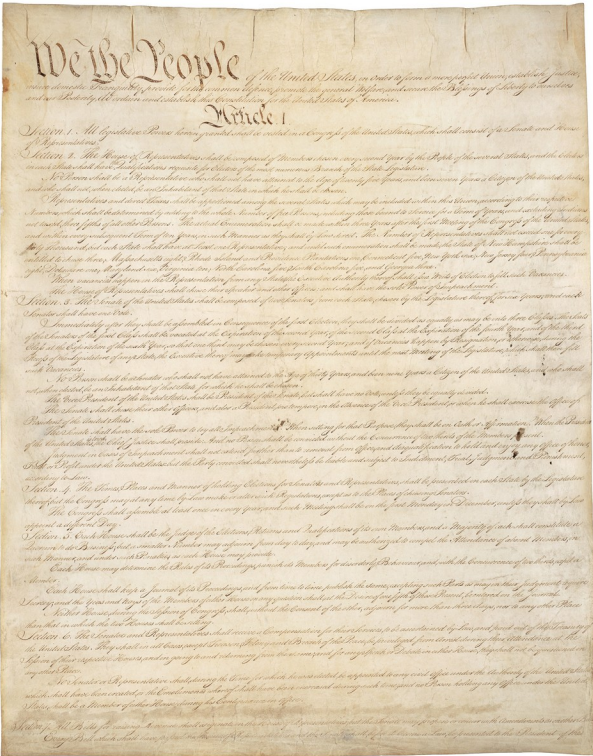
WHERE AM I? — plan your next step

Rate your understanding of this standard (1-4): ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

One thing I will review or ask about before the quiz:

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — GC.05 ⌚ ~15 min

Primary source (manuscript on parchment) — analyze it with HIPPO. Builds SSP.01-SSP.02.



U.S. Constitution, Page 1 (“We the People”) • Constitutional Convention; engrossed by Jacob Shallus • 1787

Source: U.S. National Archives • [https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Constitution_of_the_United_States_-_DPLA_-_9ca804144bd5965e992ae3528bc3c6a3_\(page_1\).jpg](https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Constitution_of_the_United_States_-_DPLA_-_9ca804144bd5965e992ae3528bc3c6a3_(page_1).jpg) Public domain — U.S. gov document, 1787
[https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Constitution_of_the_United_States_-_DPLA_-_9ca804144bd5965e992ae3528bc3c6a3_\(page_1\).jpg](https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Constitution_of_the_United_States_-_DPLA_-_9ca804144bd5965e992ae3528bc3c6a3_(page_1).jpg)

FIRST LOOK — before you analyze

Jot 3-4 things you notice in the source (details, words, people, dates). No wrong answers.

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

Primary Source Analysis — go deeper — GC.05

SUPPORT OPTION (use if you need it)

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

SOURCE SYNTHESIS — put it together (SSP.03)

In 2–3 sentences: what does this source reveal about this standard, and how do you know? Cite one specific detail from it.

THINK LIKE A HISTORIAN — corroborate or challenge (SSP.03)

Name ONE other source that could CONFIRM this one, and ONE way it could COMPLICATE or CHALLENGE it — or, whose voice is missing here?

SO WHAT? — why this source still matters today

In 1–2 sentences: why does this source still matter for understanding government today?

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit:

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — GC.05 ~8 min**RESPONSE CHOICE**

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 1 • item u1-gc05-dok1-1 • pre-field-test]

'We the People' at the start of the Preamble expresses the principle of:

- A. popular sovereignty
- B. monarchy
- C. judicial review
- D. federal supremacy

[DOK 2 • item u1-gc05-dok2-tc • pre-field-test]

The Preamble begins with the words 'We the People.' Which principle of government does this phrase express?

- A. Judicial review
- B. Separation of powers
- C. Popular sovereignty — government power comes from the people
- D. Federalism

STRETCH — think like a test-writer (open to all)

Write your OWN DOK-3 question for this standard, then a one-sentence answer key. Use the supports below — everyone can do this.

HOW TO WRITE A DOK-3 QUESTION (supports)

DOK-3 = strategic thinking: the reader must analyze, compare, evaluate, or justify using evidence — and there should be more than one defensible answer (not a fact you can just look up).

Sentence starters: “Why did _____ lead to _____?” • “Which mattered more — _____ or _____ — and why?” • “What is the BEST evidence that _____?” • “Evaluate whether _____.” • “Defend or challenge: _____.”

Frame: [Analyze / Evaluate / Justify] + [something from THIS standard] + “using evidence.”

Quick check: does my question make the reader THINK and use evidence? If yes, it's DOK-3.

NOW WRITE YOUR DOK-3 QUESTION HERE

YOUR ANSWER KEY — one clear, defensible sentence

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — GC.05 ~15 min

BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER (before you write) — How and why did the Founders build a limited constitutional republic?

Plan your argument here, then use it to write your claim, evidence, and reasoning below.

Plan your argument

Your quick notes (from this standard)

My claim (answer the prompt)

Evidence 1 (a source or fact)

Reasoning (why it proves the claim)

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Of the six purposes in the Preamble, which is most important for a free society today? Defend your claim with reasoning tied to the text.

Part

Write here

Claim

Evidence (two specifics)

Reasoning

Constructed Response — self-grade & supports — GC.05

SELF-GRADE — score your own CER against the rubric below

Reread your response, then circle the level that best fits each part. Being honest here is how you level up.

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
4 — Strong	Precise, defensible	2+ accurate, specific	Explains HOW evidence proves the claim
3 — Proficient	Clear	2 accurate	Explains the link
2 — Developing	General	1 accurate	Partial link
1 — Beginning	Unclear / missing	Missing / inaccurate	No reasoning

MY SCORE

Claim: ____ / 4 Evidence: ____ / 4 Reasoning: ____ / 4 TOTAL: ____ / 12

SUPPORTS — sentence frames (use if you need them)

Claim: “_____ because _____.”

Evidence: “One example is _____ (from _____). Another is _____.”

Reasoning: “This proves my claim because _____, which shows _____.”

REVISE — make your lowest-scoring part stronger

Pick the part you scored lowest and rewrite it here — better:

Standard GC.06 — Principles of Limited Government

TN Academic Standard GC.06: Describe limited government within the Constitution, including: checks and balances; civilian control of the military; federalism; judicial review; popular sovereignty; rule of law; separation of powers.

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can describe limited government within the Constitution, including: checks and balances; civilian control of the military; federalism; judicial review; popular sovereignty; rule of law; separation of powers..

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Every student works this standard at the same rigor: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER. Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page. Supports for each step are on the back of this page.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it? (Need help? See the back of this page.)

HOOK — think before you dig in

'If men were angels, no government would be necessary.' Since we're not angels, how did Madison design a government to guard against itself?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — before you dig in (you'll revisit this at the end)

In your own words: what do you think this standard is about, and why might it matter to you or your community? Write 2-3 sentences.

Getting Started — supports for this page — GC.06

WHAT “CORE PATH” MEANS

Everyone learns the same standard at the same level. “Support options” are just extra ways in — sentence starters, an example, a partner, or recording your answer. They help you reach the bar; they never lower it.

SET YOUR GOAL — how to write a strong one

Example goal: “By the end of this standard I can explain ___ and prove it by scoring 80%+ on the quiz.”

How to build it: name what you’ll DO, then how you’ll PROVE it, then WHEN.

Sentence starters: “I want to be able to...” “I’ll show it by...” “By the end of this standard...”

HOOK — sentence starters

“I think the big question is...” “This connects to...” “I wonder why...” “At first I believe...”

ACTIVATE — what it means & how to answer

What it means: “Activate” = wake up what you ALREADY know before you learn more.

Sentence starters: “I already know...” “This reminds me of...” “I want to find out...”

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — what to write

Just your honest first take — there is no wrong answer. Say what you THINK the standard is about and why it might matter to you, your family, or your community. You’ll come back and improve it at the end.

KEY WORDS TO WATCH FOR

Separation of Powers · Checks and Balances · Judicial Review

NOW TRY IT — draft your goal using a starter above

Write a first draft here, then copy your best version onto the front. Aim for: what you’ll DO + how you’ll PROVE it + WHEN.

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — GC.06 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Separation of Powers	Dividing government into three branches — legislative, executive, and judicial — so no one branch holds all power.	separación de poderes
Checks and Balances	The system that lets each branch limit the others (e.g., the president vetoes laws; Congress can override; courts can rule laws unconstitutional).	controles y equilibrios
Judicial Review	The power of courts to decide whether a law or government action is constitutional — established in Marbury v. Madison (1803).	revisión judicial

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Separation of Powers (sep-uh-RAY-shun); Checks and Balances (CHEKS and BAL-un-sez); Judicial Review (joo-DISH-ul ree-VYOO).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK · Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 · never seen it	2 · heard it	3 · can use it	4 · can teach it
Separation of Powers				
Checks and Balances				
Judicial Review				

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

QUICK WRITE

Which of these terms do you think will matter MOST for this standard, and why? You'll revisit this at the end.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — GC.06

~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE — three ways to complete each studio**WRITE:** fill in the four boxes below in your own words.**SAY IT:** explain the term aloud to a partner or your teacher, or record a short voice note — say the term, its meaning, and one example.**DIAGRAM:** sketch or map the term in the Sketch Studio on the back of this page.**PRIORITY TERM 1 Checks and Balances** · ES: controles y equilibrios**Word-bank meaning to build on:** The system that lets each branch limit the others (e.g., the president vetoes laws; Congress can override; courts can rule laws unconstitutional).

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Checks and Balances” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 Judicial Review · ES: revisión judicial**Word-bank meaning to build on:** The power of courts to decide whether a law or government action is constitutional — established in Marbury v. Madison (1803).

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Judicial Review” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL · build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write how one leads to or affects another on the lines — or map it in the Sketch Studio on the back.

Activity 2 — Sketch Studio (draw it or say it) — GC.06

SAY IT — pick one way to explain your terms aloud

Explain each priority term to a shoulder partner, then have them explain one back to you.

Or explain a term to your teacher during check-in.

Or record a 20–30 second voice note: say the term, what it means, and one real example.

Or stand and share one term with the class.

DIAGRAM: Checks and Balances

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

DIAGRAM: Judicial Review

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

CONNECT THE TERMS — concept map

Put both terms in the box and draw arrows to show how one leads to, needs, or affects the other. Write a few words on each arrow.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — GC.06 ⌚ ~20 min

GC.06 — Principles of Limited Government • Lean Student Deck slides 37-43 • direct-teaching slides 39-41

Your learning targets are on this standard’s opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Guiding cues	My notes — write your notes here
Key idea of this standard?	
One primary source that supports it?	
One effect on government or rights?	
Key terms →	

DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL · another way in)
Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — GC.06

UDL · CHOOSE HOW YOU CAPTURE IDEAS (same target for everyone)

Keep going with your notes: WRITE on the lines, DRAW or diagram in the box, or do both — your choice. You may also record your notes aloud.

DRAW / DIAGRAM — sketch the idea, a timeline, or how the pieces connect

WRITE — keep taking notes on the lines

Key terms to list

Separation of Powers · Checks and Balances · Judicial Review

Summary — In your own words (2-3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK · one question

In Federalist No. 51, Madison writes that 'ambition must be made to counteract ambition.' Which constitutional design does this describe?

- A. Checks and balances that let each branch limit the others
- B. Popular sovereignty
- C. Federalism between nation and states
- D. The amendment process

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ **1**

My 12-15 word headline for this standard

Guided Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.06

These scaffolds support ONLY the Cornell notes — use them to take and process those notes. Optional and easy to set aside; not a separate assignment or a label.

Key vocabulary	What it means
Separation of Powers	Dividing government into three branches — legislative, executive, and judicial — so no one branch holds all power.
Checks and Balances	The system that lets each branch limit the others (e.g., the president vetoes laws; Congress can override; courts can rule laws unconstitutional).
Judicial Review	The power of courts to decide whether a law or government action is constitutional — established in Marbury v. Madison (1803).

Break it into steps:

1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of principles of limited government was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of principles of limited government was Separation of Powers: Dividing government into three branches — legislative, executive, and judicial — so no one branch holds all power.

GUIDED NOTE REHEARSAL LAB — practice ONE note, step by step

Build one good note here first, then copy it onto your Cornell page. Name the idea → give one piece of evidence → explain the link → write a short headline.

Step	Rehearse it here
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____
Explain	_____ _____
Headline	_____ _____

TRANSFER CHECK — move one rehearsed idea onto the front notes

Light Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.06

A lighter scaffold for the SAME Cornell notes. Try the notes first; reach for this only if you need it.

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Separation of Powers	
Checks and Balances	
Judicial Review	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below (or in your front notes):

- Name the three branches of government and one job of each.
- According to Federalist No. 51, why can't we simply trust leaders to limit their own power?
- How did Marbury v. Madison strengthen the system of checks and balances?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?

Circle the Cornell cue from the front page you still need help with, and tell your teacher so we can go over it.

LIGHT PROCESSING LAB

Answer one guiding question from above in a full sentence, in your own words.

Activity 4 — Close Read — GC.06 ~15 min

Reading type: Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH

The Framers feared concentrated power, so they built limits into the Constitution's structure. Separation of powers divides government into three branches — Congress makes laws, the president executes them, the courts interpret them. Checks and balances let each branch restrain the others: the president can veto a bill, Congress can override the veto and impeach officials, and the courts can strike down unconstitutional acts through judicial review, established in *Marbury v. Madison* (1803). Other limits include federalism (power split between nation and states), the rule of law (everyone, including leaders, is bound by law), popular sovereignty, and civilian control of the military. As Madison put it in *Federalist No. 51*, 'ambition must be made to counteract ambition.'

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Key terms to know first: Separation of Powers, Checks and Balances. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

Text-dependent questions (answer in the Evidence Lab below or aloud):

1. Name the three branches of government and one job of each.
2. According to *Federalist No. 51*, why can't we simply trust leaders to limit their own power?
3. How did *Marbury v. Madison* strengthen the system of checks and balances?

RESPONSE CHOICE: answer any question by writing in the Evidence Lab, saying/recording it, or diagramming it.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB

Log evidence from the passage below.

Question / claim	Exact passage evidence	What the evidence shows

In one sentence — the main idea of this reading:

Spaced Retrieval & Reflection — GC.06

SPACED RETRIEVAL — quick recall (no notes)

Pull it up cold to strengthen memory, then check your notes — retrieval is what makes learning stick.

Recall prompt	Your answer (from memory)
One key term or fact from THIS standard	
One thing you learned in an EARLIER standard — how does it connect?	
One question you can answer now that you could not before	

CHECK YOURSELF — look back and score how it went

Got it right? ☐ Yes ☐ Partly ☐ Not yet **Answer it from memory?** ☐ Yes ☐ With a hint ☐ No

How did it feel? ☐ Confident ☐ Getting there ☐ Shaky — I'll revisit

CONNECT IT — spiral back

How does this standard connect to one you studied earlier, or to something in the world today? Write 2-3 sentences.

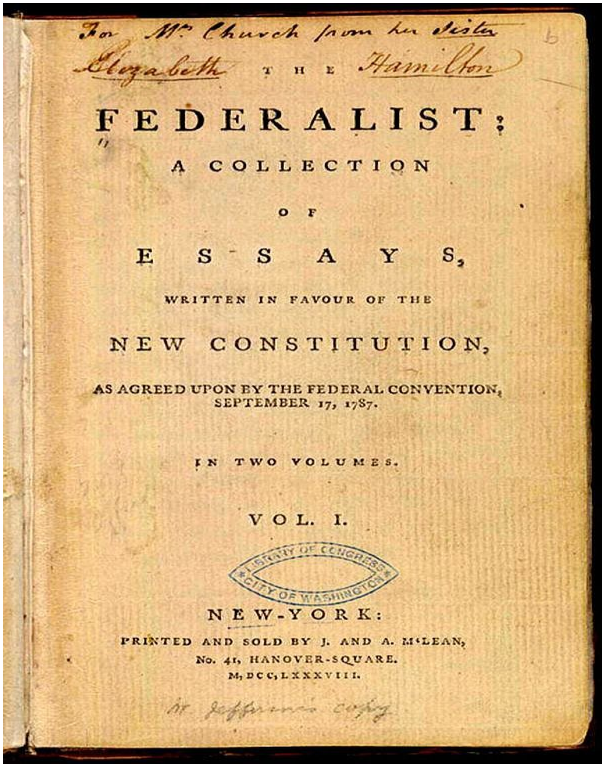
WHERE AM I? — plan your next step

Rate your understanding of this standard (1-4): ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

One thing I will review or ask about before the quiz:

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — GC.06 ⌚ ~15 min

Primary source (printed title page) — analyze it with HIPPO. Builds SSP.01–SSP.02.



The Federalist, Volume 1 (title page) • Alexander Hamilton, James Madison, John Jay ('Publius') • 1788

Source: Library of Congress, Rare Book & Special Collections • [https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:The_Federalist_\(1st_ed,_1788,_vol_I,_title_page\).jpg](https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:The_Federalist_(1st_ed,_1788,_vol_I,_title_page).jpg) Public domain — published 1788 (pre-1929) [https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:The_Federalist_\(1st_ed,_1788,_vol_I,_title_page\).jpg](https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:The_Federalist_(1st_ed,_1788,_vol_I,_title_page).jpg)

FIRST LOOK — before you analyze

Jot 3–4 things you notice in the source (details, words, people, dates). No wrong answers.

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

Primary Source Analysis — go deeper — GC.06

SUPPORT OPTION (use if you need it)

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

SOURCE SYNTHESIS — put it together (SSP.03)

In 2–3 sentences: what does this source reveal about this standard, and how do you know? Cite one specific detail from it.

THINK LIKE A HISTORIAN — corroborate or challenge (SSP.03)

Name ONE other source that could CONFIRM this one, and ONE way it could COMPLICATE or CHALLENGE it — or, whose voice is missing here?

SO WHAT? — why this source still matters today

In 1–2 sentences: why does this source still matter for understanding government today?

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit:

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — GC.06 ~8 min

RESPONSE CHOICE

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 1 · item u1-gc06-dok1-1 · pre-field-test]

The power of courts to declare a law unconstitutional is called:

- A. judicial review
- B. the veto
- C. impeachment
- D. popular sovereignty

[DOK 3 · item u1-gc06-dok3-tc · pre-field-test]

In Federalist No. 51, Madison writes that 'ambition must be made to counteract ambition.' Which constitutional design does this describe?

- A. Checks and balances that let each branch limit the others
- B. Popular sovereignty
- C. Federalism between nation and states
- D. The amendment process

STRETCH — think like a test-writer (open to all)

Write your OWN DOK-3 question for this standard, then a one-sentence answer key. Use the supports below — everyone can do this.

HOW TO WRITE A DOK-3 QUESTION (supports)

DOK-3 = strategic thinking: the reader must analyze, compare, evaluate, or justify using evidence — and there should be more than one defensible answer (not a fact you can just look up).

Sentence starters: “Why did _____ lead to _____?” · “Which mattered more — _____ or _____ — and why?” · “What is the BEST evidence that _____?” · “Evaluate whether _____.” · “Defend or challenge: _____.”

Frame: [Analyze / Evaluate / Justify] + [something from THIS standard] + “using evidence.”

Quick check: does my question make the reader THINK and use evidence? If yes, it's DOK-3.

NOW WRITE YOUR DOK-3 QUESTION HERE

YOUR ANSWER KEY — one clear, defensible sentence

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — GC.06 ⌚ ~15 min**BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER (before you write) — How and why did the Founders build a limited constitutional republic?**

Plan your argument here, then use it to write your claim, evidence, and reasoning below.

Plan your argument	Your quick notes (from this standard)
My claim (answer the prompt)	
Evidence 1 (a source or fact)	
Reasoning (why it proves the claim)	

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Which principle does the most to prevent tyranny — separation of powers, checks and balances, or federalism? Defend your claim with evidence from the sources.

Part	Write here
Claim	
Evidence (two specifics)	
Reasoning	

Constructed Response — self-grade & supports — GC.06

SELF-GRADE — score your own CER against the rubric below

Reread your response, then circle the level that best fits each part. Being honest here is how you level up.

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
4 — Strong	Precise, defensible	2+ accurate, specific	Explains HOW evidence proves the claim
3 — Proficient	Clear	2 accurate	Explains the link
2 — Developing	General	1 accurate	Partial link
1 — Beginning	Unclear / missing	Missing / inaccurate	No reasoning

MY SCORE

Claim: ____ / 4 Evidence: ____ / 4 Reasoning: ____ / 4 TOTAL: ____ / 12

SUPPORTS — sentence frames (use if you need them)

Claim: “_____ because _____.”

Evidence: “One example is _____ (from _____). Another is _____.”

Reasoning: “This proves my claim because _____, which shows _____.”

REVISE — make your lowest-scoring part stronger

Pick the part you scored lowest and rewrite it here — better:

Standard GC.07 — Structure of the Constitution & How to Amend It

TN Academic Standard GC.07: Describe the structure of the Constitution and the process to amend it.

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can describe the structure of the Constitution and the process to amend it..

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Every student works this standard at the same rigor: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER. Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page. Supports for each step are on the back of this page.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it? (Need help? See the back of this page.)

HOOK — think before you dig in

Only 27 changes in more than 230 years. Is the Constitution nearly perfect — or nearly impossible to change? Article V holds the answer.

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — before you dig in (you'll revisit this at the end)

In your own words: what do you think this standard is about, and why might it matter to you or your community? Write 2–3 sentences.

Getting Started — supports for this page — GC.07

WHAT “CORE PATH” MEANS

Everyone learns the same standard at the same level. “Support options” are just extra ways in — sentence starters, an example, a partner, or recording your answer. They help you reach the bar; they never lower it.

SET YOUR GOAL — how to write a strong one

Example goal: “By the end of this standard I can explain ___ and prove it by scoring 80%+ on the quiz.”

How to build it: name what you’ll DO, then how you’ll PROVE it, then WHEN.

Sentence starters: “I want to be able to...” “I’ll show it by...” “By the end of this standard...”

HOOK — sentence starters

“I think the big question is...” “This connects to...” “I wonder why...” “At first I believe...”

ACTIVATE — what it means & how to answer

What it means: “Activate” = wake up what you ALREADY know before you learn more.

Sentence starters: “I already know...” “This reminds me of...” “I want to find out...”

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — what to write

Just your honest first take — there is no wrong answer. Say what you THINK the standard is about and why it might matter to you, your family, or your community. You’ll come back and improve it at the end.

KEY WORDS TO WATCH FOR

Amendment · Article V · Ratification

NOW TRY IT — draft your goal using a starter above

Write a first draft here, then copy your best version onto the front. Aim for: what you’ll DO + how you’ll PROVE it + WHEN.

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — GC.07 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Amendment	A formal change or addition to the Constitution; there have been 27, beginning with the Bill of Rights.	enmienda
Article V	The part of the Constitution that sets out how it can be amended — a deliberately difficult, two-step process of proposal and ratification.	Artículo V
Ratification	Formal approval; an amendment must be ratified by three-fourths of the states (38 of 50) to take effect.	ratificación

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Amendment (uh-MEND-munt); Article V (AR-tih-kul FYV); Ratification (rat-ih-fih-KAY-shun).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK • Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 • never seen it	2 • heard it	3 • can use it	4 • can teach it
Amendment	_____	_____	_____	_____
Article V	_____	_____	_____	_____
Ratification	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

QUICK WRITE

Which of these terms do you think will matter MOST for this standard, and why? You'll revisit this at the end.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — GC.07

~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE — three ways to complete each studio**WRITE:** fill in the four boxes below in your own words.**SAY IT:** explain the term aloud to a partner or your teacher, or record a short voice note — say the term, its meaning, and one example.**DIAGRAM:** sketch or map the term in the Sketch Studio on the back of this page.**PRIORITY TERM 1 Amendment** · ES: enmienda**Word-bank meaning to build on:** A formal change or addition to the Constitution; there have been 27, beginning with the Bill of Rights.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Amendment” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 Article V · ES: Artículo V**Word-bank meaning to build on:** The part of the Constitution that sets out how it can be amended — a deliberately difficult, two-step process of proposal and ratification.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Article V” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL · build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write how one leads to or affects another on the lines — or map it in the Sketch Studio on the back.

Activity 2 — Sketch Studio (draw it or say it) — GC.07

SAY IT — pick one way to explain your terms aloud

Explain each priority term to a shoulder partner, then have them explain one back to you.

Or explain a term to your teacher during check-in.

Or record a 20–30 second voice note: say the term, what it means, and one real example.

Or stand and share one term with the class.

DIAGRAM: Amendment

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

DIAGRAM: Article V

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

CONNECT THE TERMS — concept map

Put both terms in the box and draw arrows to show how one leads to, needs, or affects the other. Write a few words on each arrow.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — GC.07 ~20 min

GC.07 — Structure of the Constitution & How to Amend It • Lean Student Deck slides 44–50 • direct-teaching slides 46–48

Your learning targets are on this standard's opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Guiding cues	My notes — write your notes here
Key idea of this standard?	
One primary source that supports it?	
One effect on government or rights?	
Key terms →	

DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL · another way in)

Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — GC.07

UDL · CHOOSE HOW YOU CAPTURE IDEAS (same target for everyone)

Keep going with your notes: WRITE on the lines, DRAW or diagram in the box, or do both — your choice. You may also record your notes aloud.

DRAW / DIAGRAM — sketch the idea, a timeline, or how the pieces connect

WRITE — keep taking notes on the lines

Key terms to list

Amendment · Article V · Ratification

Summary — In your own words (2-3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK · one question

Why did the Framers make the amendment process in Article V deliberately difficult?

- A. To make sure the Constitution could never change
- B. To let a single state change it alone
- C. To give the president control over amendments
- D. So the Constitution could adapt over time, but only with broad agreement across the country

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ **1**

My 12-15 word headline for this standard

Guided Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.07

These scaffolds support ONLY the Cornell notes — use them to take and process those notes. Optional and easy to set aside; not a separate assignment or a label.

Key vocabulary	What it means
Amendment	A formal change or addition to the Constitution; there have been 27, beginning with the Bill of Rights.
Article V	The part of the Constitution that sets out how it can be amended — a deliberately difficult, two-step process of proposal and ratification.
Ratification	Formal approval; an amendment must be ratified by three-fourths of the states (38 of 50) to take effect.

Break it into steps:

1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of structure of the constitution & how to amend it was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of structure of the constitution & how to amend it was Amendment: A formal change or addition to the Constitution; there have been 27, beginning with the Bill of Rights.

GUIDED NOTE REHEARSAL LAB — practice ONE note, step by step

Build one good note here first, then copy it onto your Cornell page. Name the idea → give one piece of evidence → explain the link → write a short headline.

Step	Rehearse it here
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____
Explain	_____ _____
Headline	_____ _____

TRANSFER CHECK — move one rehearsed idea onto the front notes

Light Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.07

A lighter scaffold for the SAME Cornell notes. Try the notes first; reach for this only if you need it.

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Amendment	
Article V	
Ratification	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below (or in your front notes):

- How many Articles does the Constitution have, and what do the first three establish?
- What are the two steps to amend the Constitution, and what fraction is required at each step?
- Why does the difficulty of Article V protect both stability and federalism?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?

Circle the Cornell cue from the front page you still need help with, and tell your teacher so we can go over it.

LIGHT PROCESSING LAB

Answer one guiding question from above in a full sentence, in your own words.

Activity 4 — Close Read — GC.07 ⌚ ~15 min

Reading type: Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH

The Constitution is short and organized: a Preamble and seven Articles. Article I creates the legislative branch (Congress), Article II the executive, Article III the judiciary; Article IV covers the states, Article V the amendment process, Article VI the supremacy of federal law, and Article VII ratification. The Framers knew the document would need to change, so Article V provides a path — but a hard one. An amendment must be proposed by two-thirds of both houses of Congress (or a national convention) and then ratified by three-fourths of the states. This high bar keeps the Constitution stable while still allowing change: in over 230 years it has been amended just 27 times.

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Key terms to know first: Amendment, Article V. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

Text-dependent questions (answer in the Evidence Lab below or aloud):

1. How many Articles does the Constitution have, and what do the first three establish?
2. What are the two steps to amend the Constitution, and what fraction is required at each step?
3. Why does the difficulty of Article V protect both stability and federalism?

RESPONSE CHOICE: answer any question by writing in the Evidence Lab, saying/recording it, or diagramming it.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB

Log evidence from the passage below.

Question / claim	Exact passage evidence	What the evidence shows

In one sentence — the main idea of this reading:

Spaced Retrieval & Reflection — GC.07

SPACED RETRIEVAL — quick recall (no notes)

Pull it up cold to strengthen memory, then check your notes — retrieval is what makes learning stick.

Recall prompt

Your answer (from memory)

One key term or fact from THIS standard

One thing you learned in an EARLIER standard — how does it connect?

One question you can answer now that you could not before

CHECK YOURSELF — look back and score how it went

Got it right? ☐ Yes ☐ Partly ☐ Not yet **Answer it from memory?** ☐ Yes ☐ With a hint ☐ No

How did it feel? ☐ Confident ☐ Getting there ☐ Shaky — I'll revisit

CONNECT IT — spiral back

How does this standard connect to one you studied earlier, or to something in the world today? Write 2-3 sentences.

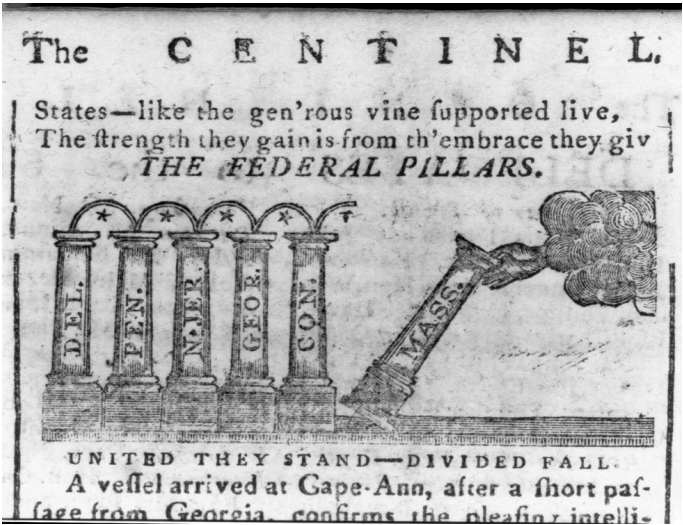
WHERE AM I? — plan your next step

Rate your understanding of this standard (1-4): ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

One thing I will review or ask about before the quiz:

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — GC.07 ~15 min

Primary source (newspaper political cartoon) — analyze it with HIPPO. Builds SSP.01–SSP.02.



The Federal Edifice (“The Federal Pillars”) • Massachusetts Centinel • 1788

Source: Library of Congress, Prints & Photographs Division · <https://www.loc.gov/item/2004676796/> Public domain — published 1788 (pre-1929) <https://www.loc.gov/item/2004676796/>

FIRST LOOK — before you analyze

Jot 3–4 things you notice in the source (details, words, people, dates). No wrong answers.

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

Primary Source Analysis — go deeper — GC.07

SUPPORT OPTION (use if you need it)

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

SOURCE SYNTHESIS — put it together (SSP.03)

In 2–3 sentences: what does this source reveal about this standard, and how do you know? Cite one specific detail from it.

THINK LIKE A HISTORIAN — corroborate or challenge (SSP.03)

Name ONE other source that could CONFIRM this one, and ONE way it could COMPLICATE or CHALLENGE it — or, whose voice is missing here?

SO WHAT? — why this source still matters today

In 1–2 sentences: why does this source still matter for understanding government today?

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit:

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — GC.07 ~8 min

RESPONSE CHOICE

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 1 · item u1-gc07-dok1-1 · pre-field-test]

To ratify a constitutional amendment requires approval by:

- A. three-fourths of the states
- B. the president
- C. a simple majority of voters
- D. the Supreme Court

[DOK 2 · item u1-gc07-dok2-tc · pre-field-test]

Why did the Framers make the amendment process in Article V deliberately difficult?

- A. To make sure the Constitution could never change
- B. To let a single state change it alone
- C. To give the president control over amendments
- D. So the Constitution could adapt over time, but only with broad agreement across the country

STRETCH — think like a test-writer (open to all)

Write your OWN DOK-3 question for this standard, then a one-sentence answer key. Use the supports below — everyone can do this.

HOW TO WRITE A DOK-3 QUESTION (supports)

DOK-3 = strategic thinking: the reader must analyze, compare, evaluate, or justify using evidence — and there should be more than one defensible answer (not a fact you can just look up).

Sentence starters: “Why did _____ lead to _____?” · “Which mattered more — _____ or _____ — and why?” · “What is the BEST evidence that _____?” · “Evaluate whether _____.” · “Defend or challenge: _____.”

Frame: [Analyze / Evaluate / Justify] + [something from THIS standard] + “using evidence.”

Quick check: does my question make the reader THINK and use evidence? If yes, it's DOK-3.

NOW WRITE YOUR DOK-3 QUESTION HERE

YOUR ANSWER KEY — one clear, defensible sentence

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — GC.07 ⌚ ~15 min**BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER (before you write) — How and why did the Founders build a limited constitutional republic?**

Plan your argument here, then use it to write your claim, evidence, and reasoning below.

Plan your argument	Your quick notes (from this standard)
My claim (answer the prompt)	
Evidence 1 (a source or fact)	
Reasoning (why it proves the claim)	

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Is the difficulty of amending the Constitution a strength or a weakness for a modern democracy? Defend your claim with reasoning tied to Article V.

Part	Write here
Claim	
Evidence (two specifics)	
Reasoning	

Constructed Response — self-grade & supports — GC.07

SELF-GRADE — score your own CER against the rubric below

Reread your response, then circle the level that best fits each part. Being honest here is how you level up.

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
4 — Strong	Precise, defensible	2+ accurate, specific	Explains HOW evidence proves the claim
3 — Proficient	Clear	2 accurate	Explains the link
2 — Developing	General	1 accurate	Partial link
1 — Beginning	Unclear / missing	Missing / inaccurate	No reasoning

MY SCORE

Claim: ____ / 4 Evidence: ____ / 4 Reasoning: ____ / 4 TOTAL: ____ / 12

SUPPORTS — sentence frames (use if you need them)

Claim: “_____ because _____.”

Evidence: “One example is _____ (from _____). Another is _____.”

Reasoning: “This proves my claim because _____, which shows _____.”

REVISE — make your lowest-scoring part stronger

Pick the part you scored lowest and rewrite it here — better:

Standard GC.08 — The Bill of Rights

TN Academic Standard GC.08: Analyze how the Bill of Rights limits the powers of the government and ensures individual rights. (C)

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can analyze how the Bill of Rights limits the powers of the government and ensures individual rights..

Lenses for this standard: Culture (C)

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Every student works this standard at the same rigor: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER. Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page. Supports for each step are on the back of this page.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it? (Need help? See the back of this page.)

HOOK — think before you dig in

Ten amendments, one purpose: to tell the government what it may NOT do to you. Why did Americans insist on adding them?

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — before you dig in (you'll revisit this at the end)

In your own words: what do you think this standard is about, and why might it matter to you or your community? Write 2–3 sentences.

Getting Started — supports for this page — GC.08

WHAT “CORE PATH” MEANS

Everyone learns the same standard at the same level. “Support options” are just extra ways in — sentence starters, an example, a partner, or recording your answer. They help you reach the bar; they never lower it.

SET YOUR GOAL — how to write a strong one

Example goal: “By the end of this standard I can explain ___ and prove it by scoring 80%+ on the quiz.”

How to build it: name what you’ll DO, then how you’ll PROVE it, then WHEN.

Sentence starters: “I want to be able to...” “I’ll show it by...” “By the end of this standard...”

HOOK — sentence starters

“I think the big question is...” “This connects to...” “I wonder why...” “At first I believe...”

ACTIVATE — what it means & how to answer

What it means: “Activate” = wake up what you ALREADY know before you learn more.

Sentence starters: “I already know...” “This reminds me of...” “I want to find out...”

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — what to write

Just your honest first take — there is no wrong answer. Say what you THINK the standard is about and why it might matter to you, your family, or your community. You’ll come back and improve it at the end.

KEY WORDS TO WATCH FOR

Bill of Rights · Reserved Powers · Due Process

NOW TRY IT — draft your goal using a starter above

Write a first draft here, then copy your best version onto the front. Aim for: what you’ll DO + how you’ll PROVE it + WHEN.

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — GC.08 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Bill of Rights	The first ten amendments to the Constitution (1791), which protect individual freedoms and limit the power of government.	Carta de Derechos
Reserved Powers	Powers kept by the states or the people, not given to the national government — protected by the Tenth Amendment.	poderes reservados
Due Process	The requirement that government follow fair legal procedures before taking a person's life, liberty, or property — guaranteed by the Fifth Amendment.	debido proceso

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Bill of Rights (BIL of RYTS); Reserved Powers (ree-ZURVD POW-erz); Due Process (DOO PROSS-ess).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK · Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 · never seen it	2 · heard it	3 · can use it	4 · can teach it
Bill of Rights	_____	_____	_____	_____
Reserved Powers	_____	_____	_____	_____
Due Process	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

QUICK WRITE

Which of these terms do you think will matter MOST for this standard, and why? You'll revisit this at the end.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — GC.08

~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE — three ways to complete each studio**WRITE:** fill in the four boxes below in your own words.**SAY IT:** explain the term aloud to a partner or your teacher, or record a short voice note — say the term, its meaning, and one example.**DIAGRAM:** sketch or map the term in the Sketch Studio on the back of this page.**PRIORITY TERM 1 Bill of Rights** · ES: Carta de Derechos**Word-bank meaning to build on:** The first ten amendments to the Constitution (1791), which protect individual freedoms and limit the power of government.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Bill of Rights” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 Reserved Powers · ES: poderes reservados**Word-bank meaning to build on:** Powers kept by the states or the people, not given to the national government — protected by the Tenth Amendment.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Reserved Powers” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL · build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write how one leads to or affects another on the lines — or map it in the Sketch Studio on the back.

Activity 2 — Sketch Studio (draw it or say it) — GC.08

SAY IT — pick one way to explain your terms aloud

Explain each priority term to a shoulder partner, then have them explain one back to you.

Or explain a term to your teacher during check-in.

Or record a 20–30 second voice note: say the term, what it means, and one real example.

Or stand and share one term with the class.

DIAGRAM: Bill of Rights

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

DIAGRAM: Reserved Powers

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

CONNECT THE TERMS — concept map

Put both terms in the box and draw arrows to show how one leads to, needs, or affects the other. Write a few words on each arrow.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — GC.08 ~20 min

GC.08 — The Bill of Rights • Lean Student Deck slides 51-57 • direct-teaching slides 53-55

Your learning targets are on this standard's opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Guiding cues	My notes — write your notes here
Key idea of this standard?	
One primary source that supports it?	
One effect on government or rights?	
Key terms →	

DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL · another way in)

Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — GC.08

UDL · CHOOSE HOW YOU CAPTURE IDEAS (same target for everyone)

Keep going with your notes: WRITE on the lines, DRAW or diagram in the box, or do both — your choice. You may also record your notes aloud.

DRAW / DIAGRAM — sketch the idea, a timeline, or how the pieces connect

WRITE — keep taking notes on the lines

Key terms to list

Bill of Rights · Reserved Powers · Due Process

Summary — In your own words (2-3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK · one question

The First Amendment begins 'Congress shall make no law...' Why does the Bill of Rights phrase protections as limits on the government rather than as gifts to the people?

- A. To show the government created these rights and can remove them
- B. Because the Framers saw rights as belonging to people already — the Constitution's job is to stop government from violating them
- C. To give Congress more power over speech and religion
- D. Because only Congress has rights

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ **1**

My 12-15 word headline for this standard

Guided Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.08

These scaffolds support ONLY the Cornell notes — use them to take and process those notes. Optional and easy to set aside; not a separate assignment or a label.

Key vocabulary	What it means
Bill of Rights	The first ten amendments to the Constitution (1791), which protect individual freedoms and limit the power of government.
Reserved Powers	Powers kept by the states or the people, not given to the national government — protected by the Tenth Amendment.
Due Process	The requirement that government follow fair legal procedures before taking a person's life, liberty, or property — guaranteed by the Fifth Amendment.

Break it into steps:

1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of the bill of rights was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of the bill of rights was Bill of Rights: The first ten amendments to the Constitution (1791), which protect individual freedoms and limit the power of government.

GUIDED NOTE REHEARSAL LAB — practice ONE note, step by step

Build one good note here first, then copy it onto your Cornell page. Name the idea → give one piece of evidence → explain the link → write a short headline.

Step	Rehearse it here
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____
Explain	_____ _____
Headline	_____ _____

TRANSFER CHECK — move one rehearsed idea onto the front notes

Light Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.08

A lighter scaffold for the SAME Cornell notes. Try the notes first; reach for this only if you need it.

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Bill of Rights	
Reserved Powers	
Due Process	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below (or in your front notes):

- List three freedoms protected by the First Amendment.
- According to the Tenth Amendment, who keeps the powers not given to the national government?
- Why does it matter that the Bill of Rights protects 'persons' and not only citizens?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?

Circle the Cornell cue from the front page you still need help with, and tell your teacher so we can go over it.

LIGHT PROCESSING LAB

Answer one guiding question from above in a full sentence, in your own words.

Activity 4 — Close Read — GC.08 ⌚ ~15 min

Reading type: Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH

The Anti-Federalists agreed to the Constitution only if a bill of rights was added. In 1791 the first ten amendments were ratified. The Bill of Rights protects individual freedoms and, notably, most protections apply to 'persons,' not only citizens. The First Amendment guards religion, speech, press, assembly, and petition. The Fourth through Eighth protect people accused of crimes — from unreasonable searches to cruel and unusual punishment — through guarantees like due process. The Ninth Amendment says the people keep other rights not listed, and the Tenth reserves to the states and the people all powers not given to the national government — a cornerstone of federalism. Every clause is a limit on government power. This standard is required instruction under Tennessee law (T.C.A. § 49-6-1028).

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Key terms to know first: Bill of Rights, Reserved Powers. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

Text-dependent questions (answer in the Evidence Lab below or aloud):

1. List three freedoms protected by the First Amendment.
2. According to the Tenth Amendment, who keeps the powers not given to the national government?
3. Why does it matter that the Bill of Rights protects 'persons' and not only citizens?

RESPONSE CHOICE: answer any question by writing in the Evidence Lab, saying/recording it, or diagramming it.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB

Log evidence from the passage below.

Question / claim	Exact passage evidence	What the evidence shows

In one sentence — the main idea of this reading:

Spaced Retrieval & Reflection — GC.08

SPACED RETRIEVAL — quick recall (no notes)

Pull it up cold to strengthen memory, then check your notes — retrieval is what makes learning stick.

Recall prompt

Your answer (from memory)

One key term or fact from THIS standard

One thing you learned in an EARLIER standard — how does it connect?

One question you can answer now that you could not before

CHECK YOURSELF — look back and score how it went

Got it right? ☐ Yes ☐ Partly ☐ Not yet **Answer it from memory?** ☐ Yes ☐ With a hint ☐ No

How did it feel? ☐ Confident ☐ Getting there ☐ Shaky — I'll revisit

CONNECT IT — spiral back

How does this standard connect to one you studied earlier, or to something in the world today? Write 2-3 sentences.

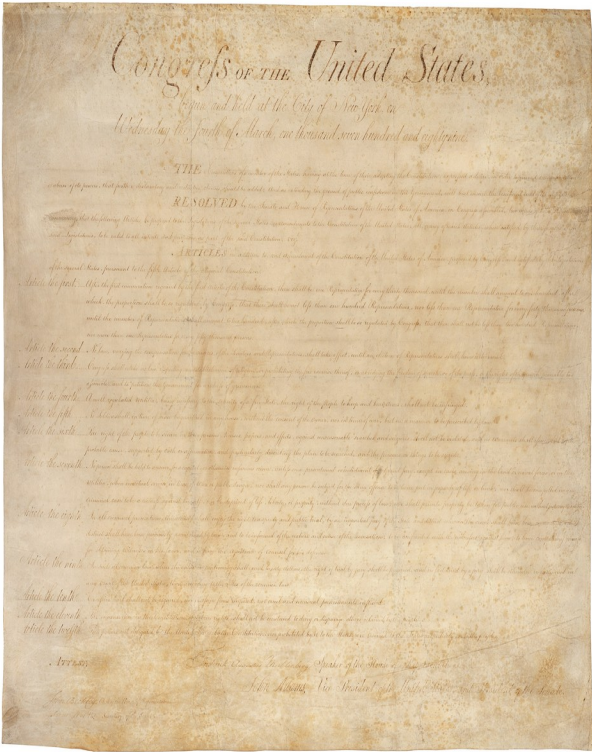
WHERE AM I? — plan your next step

Rate your understanding of this standard (1-4): ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

One thing I will review or ask about before the quiz:

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — GC.08 ~15 min

Primary source (manuscript on parchment) — analyze it with HIPPO. Builds SSP.01-SSP.02.



The Bill of Rights (engrossed copy) • 1st U.S. Congress • 1789

Source: U.S. National Archives • https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Bill_of_Rights_Pg1of1_AC.jpg Public domain — U.S. gov document, 1789 https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Bill_of_Rights_Pg1of1_AC.jpg

FIRST LOOK — before you analyze

Jot 3-4 things you notice in the source (details, words, people, dates). No wrong answers.

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

Primary Source Analysis — go deeper — GC.08

SUPPORT OPTION (use if you need it)

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

SOURCE SYNTHESIS — put it together (SSP.03)

In 2–3 sentences: what does this source reveal about this standard, and how do you know? Cite one specific detail from it.

THINK LIKE A HISTORIAN — corroborate or challenge (SSP.03)

Name ONE other source that could CONFIRM this one, and ONE way it could COMPLICATE or CHALLENGE it — or, whose voice is missing here?

SO WHAT? — why this source still matters today

In 1–2 sentences: why does this source still matter for understanding government today?

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit:

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — GC.08 ~8 min

RESPONSE CHOICE

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 1 • item u1-gc08-dok1-1 • pre-field-test]

The Bill of Rights is the name for:

- A. the first ten amendments to the Constitution
- B. the Preamble
- C. the Articles of Confederation
- D. the Declaration of Independence

[DOK 3 • item u1-gc08-dok3-tc • pre-field-test]

The First Amendment begins 'Congress shall make no law...' Why does the Bill of Rights phrase protections as limits on the government rather than as gifts to the people?

- A. To show the government created these rights and can remove them
- B. Because the Framers saw rights as belonging to people already — the Constitution's job is to stop government from violating them
- C. To give Congress more power over speech and religion
- D. Because only Congress has rights

STRETCH — think like a test-writer (open to all)

Write your OWN DOK-3 question for this standard, then a one-sentence answer key. Use the supports below — everyone can do this.

HOW TO WRITE A DOK-3 QUESTION (supports)

DOK-3 = strategic thinking: the reader must analyze, compare, evaluate, or justify using evidence — and there should be more than one defensible answer (not a fact you can just look up).

Sentence starters: “Why did _____ lead to _____?” • “Which mattered more — _____ or _____ — and why?” • “What is the BEST evidence that _____?” • “Evaluate whether _____.” • “Defend or challenge: _____.”

Frame: [Analyze / Evaluate / Justify] + [something from THIS standard] + “using evidence.”

Quick check: does my question make the reader THINK and use evidence? If yes, it's DOK-3.

NOW WRITE YOUR DOK-3 QUESTION HERE

YOUR ANSWER KEY — one clear, defensible sentence

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — GC.08 ~15 min

BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER (before you write) — How and why did the Founders build a limited constitutional republic?

Plan your argument here, then use it to write your claim, evidence, and reasoning below.

Plan your argument

Your quick notes (from this standard)

My claim (answer the prompt)

Evidence 1 (a source or fact)

Reasoning (why it proves the claim)

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Which amendment in the Bill of Rights does the most to protect individual liberty today? Defend your claim with evidence from the text.

Part

Write here

Claim

Evidence (two specifics)

Reasoning

Constructed Response — self-grade & supports — GC.08

SELF-GRADE — score your own CER against the rubric below

Reread your response, then circle the level that best fits each part. Being honest here is how you level up.

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
4 — Strong	Precise, defensible	2+ accurate, specific	Explains HOW evidence proves the claim
3 — Proficient	Clear	2 accurate	Explains the link
2 — Developing	General	1 accurate	Partial link
1 — Beginning	Unclear / missing	Missing / inaccurate	No reasoning

MY SCORE

Claim: ____ / 4 Evidence: ____ / 4 Reasoning: ____ / 4 TOTAL: ____ / 12

SUPPORTS — sentence frames (use if you need them)

Claim: “_____ because _____.”

Evidence: “One example is _____ (from _____). Another is _____.”

Reasoning: “This proves my claim because _____, which shows _____.”

REVISE — make your lowest-scoring part stronger

Pick the part you scored lowest and rewrite it here — better:

Standard GC.09 — Republic and Democracy

TN Academic Standard GC.09: Define the concepts of democracy and republic and examine the relationship between the two.

LEARNING TARGETS — I can...

- I can define the concepts of democracy and republic and examine the relationship between the two..

CORE PATH — the same for every student

Every student works this standard at the same rigor: analyze the sources and vocabulary, then show what you learned on the Practice Quiz and the CER. Check yourself against the learning targets on the Cornell Notes page. Supports for each step are on the back of this page.

SET YOUR GOAL (self-direction)

My goal for this standard — what will I be able to do, and how will I show it? (Need help? See the back of this page.)

HOOK — think before you dig in

Is the United States a democracy or a republic? The answer is 'both, on purpose' — and it changes how your voice reaches government.

ACTIVATE — what do you already know or wonder?

Jot what you already know or want to find out about this standard. You'll come back to it.

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — before you dig in (you'll revisit this at the end)

In your own words: what do you think this standard is about, and why might it matter to you or your community? Write 2–3 sentences.

Getting Started — supports for this page — GC.09

WHAT “CORE PATH” MEANS

Everyone learns the same standard at the same level. “Support options” are just extra ways in — sentence starters, an example, a partner, or recording your answer. They help you reach the bar; they never lower it.

SET YOUR GOAL — how to write a strong one

Example goal: “By the end of this standard I can explain ___ and prove it by scoring 80%+ on the quiz.”

How to build it: name what you’ll DO, then how you’ll PROVE it, then WHEN.

Sentence starters: “I want to be able to...” “I’ll show it by...” “By the end of this standard...”

HOOK — sentence starters

“I think the big question is...” “This connects to...” “I wonder why...” “At first I believe...”

ACTIVATE — what it means & how to answer

What it means: “Activate” = wake up what you ALREADY know before you learn more.

Sentence starters: “I already know...” “This reminds me of...” “I want to find out...”

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — what to write

Just your honest first take — there is no wrong answer. Say what you THINK the standard is about and why it might matter to you, your family, or your community. You’ll come back and improve it at the end.

KEY WORDS TO WATCH FOR

Republic · Representative Democracy · Direct Democracy

NOW TRY IT — draft your goal using a starter above

Write a first draft here, then copy your best version onto the front. Aim for: what you’ll DO + how you’ll PROVE it + WHEN.

Activity 1 — Vocabulary (Part A: Reference / Word Bank) — GC.09 ~10 min

Use this word bank throughout the standard. The Spanish column supports access, not translation of assessment.

Term	Student-friendly meaning	Spanish
Republic	A government in which citizens elect representatives to make laws and decisions on their behalf.	república
Representative Democracy	A system in which the people rule indirectly by electing officials to represent them — the model of U.S. government.	democracia representativa
Direct Democracy	A system in which citizens vote directly on laws themselves, rather than through elected representatives.	democracia directa

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Pronunciations: Republic (ree-PUB-lik); Representative Democracy (rep-ree-ZEN-tuh-tiv); Direct Democracy (dih-REKT dih-MOK-ruh-see).

VOCABULARY SELF-CHECK • Knowledge Rating

Rate each term NOW in pencil, then again at the END — growth is the goal; no penalty for “never seen it.”

Term	1 • never seen it	2 • heard it	3 • can use it	4 • can teach it
Republic	_____	_____	_____	_____
Representative Democracy	_____	_____	_____	_____
Direct Democracy	_____	_____	_____	_____

MAKE IT YOURS (RESPONSE CHOICE): choose ONE term above and show you own it — write a sentence, sketch it, or give a real-world example.

QUICK WRITE

Which of these terms do you think will matter MOST for this standard, and why? You'll revisit this at the end.

Activity 2 — Vocabulary Studio (Frayer-inspired) — GC.09

~7 min

RESPONSE CHOICE — three ways to complete each studio**WRITE:** fill in the four boxes below in your own words.**SAY IT:** explain the term aloud to a partner or your teacher, or record a short voice note — say the term, its meaning, and one example.**DIAGRAM:** sketch or map the term in the Sketch Studio on the back of this page.**PRIORITY TERM 1 Republic** · ES: república**Word-bank meaning to build on:** A government in which citizens elect representatives to make laws and decisions on their behalf.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Republic” to explain this standard.

PRIORITY TERM 2 Direct Democracy · ES: democracia directa**Word-bank meaning to build on:** A system in which citizens vote directly on laws themselves, rather than through elected representatives.

Definition (in your own words)	Characteristics
Examples	Non-examples

Use it to explain

Write one sentence that uses “Direct Democracy” to explain this standard.

CONNECT THE TERMS (UDL · build understanding)

How do these priority terms fit together? Write how one leads to or affects another on the lines — or map it in the Sketch Studio on the back.

Activity 2 — Sketch Studio (draw it or say it) — GC.09

SAY IT — pick one way to explain your terms aloud

Explain each priority term to a shoulder partner, then have them explain one back to you.

Or explain a term to your teacher during check-in.

Or record a 20–30 second voice note: say the term, what it means, and one real example.

Or stand and share one term with the class.

DIAGRAM: Republic

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

DIAGRAM: Direct Democracy

Draw, map, or symbolize this term — a picture, an icon, a quick web, or an example scene. Label your drawing.

CONNECT THE TERMS — concept map

Put both terms in the box and draw arrows to show how one leads to, needs, or affects the other. Write a few words on each arrow.

Activity 3 — Direct Teaching Cornell Notes — GC.09 ~20 min

GC.09 — Republic and Democracy • Lean Student Deck slides 58–64 • direct-teaching slides 60–62

Your learning targets are on this standard’s opening page — take notes that help you meet them.

Guiding cues	My notes — write your notes here
Key idea of this standard?	
One primary source that supports it?	
One effect on government or rights?	
Key terms →	

DOODLE ZONE — draw your thinking (UDL · another way in)
Need another way in? Sketch the key idea, a quick timeline, or how the pieces connect. Words optional.

Cornell Notes — keep going, then process & check — GC.09

UDL · CHOOSE HOW YOU CAPTURE IDEAS (same target for everyone)

Keep going with your notes: WRITE on the lines, DRAW or diagram in the box, or do both — your choice. You may also record your notes aloud.

DRAW / DIAGRAM — sketch the idea, a timeline, or how the pieces connect

WRITE — keep taking notes on the lines

Key terms to list

Republic · Representative Democracy · Direct Democracy

Summary — In your own words (2-3 sentences)

PROGRESS CHECK · one question

What is the main difference between a direct democracy and a republic (representative democracy)?

- A. In a direct democracy citizens vote on laws themselves; in a republic they elect representatives to make laws
- B. A republic has no elections
- C. A republic is ruled by a king
- D. There is no difference

Commit before you move on — mark it, say it, or explain it aloud.

CHECK YOURSELF — how am I doing?

Which learning targets (on this standard's opening page) can you now meet? Tick the number; circle any you still need help with.

☐ **1**

My 12-15 word headline for this standard

Guided Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.09

These scaffolds support ONLY the Cornell notes — use them to take and process those notes. Optional and easy to set aside; not a separate assignment or a label.

Key vocabulary	What it means
Republic	A government in which citizens elect representatives to make laws and decisions on their behalf.
Representative Democracy	A system in which the people rule indirectly by electing officials to represent them — the model of U.S. government.
Direct Democracy	A system in which citizens vote directly on laws themselves, rather than through elected representatives.

Break it into steps:

1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of republic and democracy was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of republic and democracy was Republic: A government in which citizens elect representatives to make laws and decisions on their behalf.

GUIDED NOTE REHEARSAL LAB — practice ONE note, step by step

Build one good note here first, then copy it onto your Cornell page. Name the idea → give one piece of evidence → explain the link → write a short headline.

Step	Rehearse it here
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____
Explain	_____ _____
Headline	_____ _____

TRANSFER CHECK — move one rehearsed idea onto the front notes

Light Support for the Cornell Notes — GC.09

A lighter scaffold for the SAME Cornell notes. Try the notes first; reach for this only if you need it.

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Republic	
Representative Democracy	
Direct Democracy	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below (or in your front notes):

- What is the difference between a direct democracy and a representative democracy (republic)?
- In Federalist No. 10, why does Madison prefer a large republic over a pure democracy?
- How does a constitutional republic balance majority rule with minority rights?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?

Circle the Cornell cue from the front page you still need help with, and tell your teacher so we can go over it.

LIGHT PROCESSING LAB

Answer one guiding question from above in a full sentence, in your own words.

Activity 4 — Close Read — GC.09 ~15 min

Reading type: Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis. This is not a primary source. Builds SSP.03 (synthesize) and SSP.05 (historical awareness).

CORE PATH

Americans often call the United States a 'democracy,' but the Framers designed a republic — a representative democracy. In a direct democracy, citizens vote on laws themselves; in a republic, they elect representatives to make laws for them. In Federalist No. 10, Madison argued a large republic would better control the dangers of 'faction' than a small direct democracy. The Constitution guarantees every state 'a Republican Form of Government' (Article IV). A constitutional republic combines majority rule through elections with protection of minority rights and individual liberties through the Constitution — so the majority governs, but cannot simply vote away the basic rights of others.

LANGUAGE SUPPORT

Key terms to know first: Republic, Representative Democracy. Read once for the gist, then again for evidence.

Text-dependent questions (answer in the Evidence Lab below or aloud):

- 1. What is the difference between a direct democracy and a representative democracy (republic)?
- 2. In Federalist No. 10, why does Madison prefer a large republic over a pure democracy?
- 3. How does a constitutional republic balance majority rule with minority rights?

RESPONSE CHOICE: answer any question by writing in the Evidence Lab, saying/recording it, or diagramming it.

CLOSE-READ EVIDENCE LAB

Log evidence from the passage below.

Question / claim	Exact passage evidence	What the evidence shows

In one sentence — the main idea of this reading:

Spaced Retrieval & Reflection — GC.09

SPACED RETRIEVAL — quick recall (no notes)

Pull it up cold to strengthen memory, then check your notes — retrieval is what makes learning stick.

Recall prompt

Your answer (from memory)

One key term or fact from THIS standard

One thing you learned in an EARLIER standard — how does it connect?

One question you can answer now that you could not before

CHECK YOURSELF — look back and score how it went

Got it right? ☐ Yes ☐ Partly ☐ Not yet **Answer it from memory?** ☐ Yes ☐ With a hint ☐ No

How did it feel? ☐ Confident ☐ Getting there ☐ Shaky — I'll revisit

CONNECT IT — spiral back

How does this standard connect to one you studied earlier, or to something in the world today? Write 2-3 sentences.

WHERE AM I? — plan your next step

Rate your understanding of this standard (1-4): ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4

One thing I will review or ask about before the quiz:

Activity 5 — Primary Source / Data Analysis — GC.09 ~15 min

Primary source (engraved national emblem) — analyze it with HIPPO. Builds SSP.01–SSP.02.



Great Seal of the United States (obverse) • Charles Thomson & William Barton (design) • 1782

Source: U.S. National Archives / public domain (U.S. government emblem) • [https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Great_Seal_of_the_United_States_\(obverse\).svg](https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Great_Seal_of_the_United_States_(obverse).svg) Public domain — U.S. federal government work [https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Great_Seal_of_the_United_States_\(obverse\).svg](https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Great_Seal_of_the_United_States_(obverse).svg)

FIRST LOOK — before you analyze
Jot 3–4 things you notice in the source (details, words, people, dates). No wrong answers.

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
H — Historical context: what was happening when this was created?	
I — Intended audience: who was meant to see or obey it?	
P — Purpose: why was it created?	

HIPPO — analyze the source (prompt)	Your analysis
P — Point of view: whose perspective does it reflect?	
O — Outside connection: how does it connect to this standard?	

Primary Source Analysis — go deeper — GC.09

SUPPORT OPTION (use if you need it)

Sentence frame: This source shows _____ because it _____, which reveals _____.

SOURCE SYNTHESIS — put it together (SSP.03)

In 2–3 sentences: what does this source reveal about this standard, and how do you know? Cite one specific detail from it.

THINK LIKE A HISTORIAN — corroborate or challenge (SSP.03)

Name ONE other source that could CONFIRM this one, and ONE way it could COMPLICATE or CHALLENGE it — or, whose voice is missing here?

SO WHAT? — why this source still matters today

In 1–2 sentences: why does this source still matter for understanding government today?

CONFIDENCE CHECK-IN

Rate your understanding of this standard (1–4): _____ One thing to revisit:

Activity 6 — Core Application: Practice Quiz — GC.09 ~8 min**RESPONSE CHOICE**

Commit to an answer by marking it, saying it, or explaining it aloud before checking. Answer key is in the Teacher Guide (kept separate).

[DOK 1 · item u1-gc09-dok1-1 · pre-field-test]

The United States is best described as a:

- A. constitutional republic / representative democracy
- B. direct democracy
- C. monarchy
- D. confederation

[DOK 2 · item u1-gc09-dok2-tc · pre-field-test]

What is the main difference between a direct democracy and a republic (representative democracy)?

- A. In a direct democracy citizens vote on laws themselves; in a republic they elect representatives to make laws
- B. A republic has no elections
- C. A republic is ruled by a king
- D. There is no difference

STRETCH — think like a test-writer (open to all)

Write your OWN DOK-3 question for this standard, then a one-sentence answer key. Use the supports below — everyone can do this.

HOW TO WRITE A DOK-3 QUESTION (supports)

DOK-3 = strategic thinking: the reader must analyze, compare, evaluate, or justify using evidence — and there should be more than one defensible answer (not a fact you can just look up).

Sentence starters: “Why did _____ lead to _____?” · “Which mattered more — _____ or _____ — and why?” · “What is the BEST evidence that _____?” · “Evaluate whether _____.” · “Defend or challenge: _____.”

Frame: [Analyze / Evaluate / Justify] + [something from THIS standard] + “using evidence.”

Quick check: does my question make the reader THINK and use evidence? If yes, it's DOK-3.

NOW WRITE YOUR DOK-3 QUESTION HERE

YOUR ANSWER KEY — one clear, defensible sentence

Activity 7 — Constructed Response (CER) — GC.09 ~15 min

BIG-QUESTION ORGANIZER (before you write) — How and why did the Founders build a limited constitutional republic?

Plan your argument here, then use it to write your claim, evidence, and reasoning below.

Plan your argument

Your quick notes (from this standard)

My claim (answer the prompt)

Evidence 1 (a source or fact)

Reasoning (why it proves the claim)

CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE (CER) — builds SSP.04 Argumentation

Claim + Evidence + Reasoning: Was the Framers' choice of a republic over a direct democracy the right one for a large nation? Defend your claim using Federalist No. 10.

Part

Write here

Claim

Evidence (two specifics)

Reasoning

Constructed Response — self-grade & supports — GC.09

SELF-GRADE — score your own CER against the rubric below

Reread your response, then circle the level that best fits each part. Being honest here is how you level up.

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
4 — Strong	Precise, defensible	2+ accurate, specific	Explains HOW evidence proves the claim
3 — Proficient	Clear	2 accurate	Explains the link
2 — Developing	General	1 accurate	Partial link
1 — Beginning	Unclear / missing	Missing / inaccurate	No reasoning

MY SCORE

Claim: ____ / 4 Evidence: ____ / 4 Reasoning: ____ / 4 TOTAL: ____ / 12

SUPPORTS — sentence frames (use if you need them)

Claim: “_____ because _____.”

Evidence: “One example is _____ (from _____). Another is _____.”

Reasoning: “This proves my claim because _____, which shows _____.”

REVISE — make your lowest-scoring part stronger

Pick the part you scored lowest and rewrite it here — better:

Your Tennessee Connection

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

Tennessee entered the Union in 1796 as the 16th state. Its own state constitution echoes the federal design studied in this unit — a separation of powers among three branches and a Declaration of Rights modeled on the Bill of Rights (GC.06, GC.08).

Reflect (RESPONSE CHOICE): How does a Tennessee connection change the way you understand a national idea? Answer by writing, recording, or diagramming.

Tennessee Civics Investigation

Tennessee's government mirrors the federal framework. Investigate one way your state or local government reflects a principle from this unit — separation of powers, checks and balances, or the protection of individual rights — and record what you find.

Prompt	Your findings
A Tennessee example connected to this unit	

Prompt	Your findings
One source I could check (library, TN Secretary of State, TSLA, a representative's office)	
How it connects to a standard in this unit	
One question I still have	

Progress Tracker & Cumulative Review

Track your Progress Check result for each standard and note one thing to revisit.

Standard	Progress Check (✓ / reteach)	One thing to revisit
GC.01		
GC.02		
GC.03		
GC.04		
GC.05		
GC.06		
GC.07		
GC.08		
GC.09		

Optional Extension Bank (higher-DOK, open to all)

Any student may choose an extension. These are EXTENSION, not a track.

GC.01: Which European root — Locke's natural rights, Montesquieu's separated powers, or Magna Carta's limits on the king — shaped American government the most? Defend your claim with evidence from two sources.

GC.02: Was the Declaration of Independence mainly a list of complaints, or an argument about the purpose of government? Defend your claim with two quotations from the text.

GC.03: Was the greatest weakness of the Articles the lack of taxing power, the lack of a strong executive, or the difficulty of amendment? Defend your claim with evidence.

GC.04: In the ratification debate, whose warning has aged better — the Federalists' case for a strong union, or the Anti-Federalists' fear of centralized power? Use one quote from each side.

GC.05: Of the six purposes in the Preamble, which is most important for a free society today? Defend your claim with reasoning tied to the text.

GC.06: Which principle does the most to prevent tyranny — separation of powers, checks and balances, or federalism? Defend your claim with evidence from the sources.

GC.07: Is the difficulty of amending the Constitution a strength or a weakness for a modern democracy? Defend your claim with reasoning tied to Article V.

GC.08: Which amendment in the Bill of Rights does the most to protect individual liberty today? Defend your claim with evidence from the text.

GC.09: Was the Framers' choice of a republic over a direct democracy the right one for a large nation? Defend your claim using Federalist No. 10.

Reusable Toolkit & Source Library

Written Response Rubric (CER)

Level	Claim	Evidence	Reasoning
4 — Strong	Precise, defensible	2+ accurate, specific	Explains how evidence proves the claim
3 — Proficient	Clear	2 accurate	Explains the link
2 — Developing	General	1 accurate	Partial link
1 — Beginning	Unclear/missing	Missing/inaccurate	No reasoning

Source Library — full citations & clickable links

GC.01 — Enlightenment Roots of American Government

Second Treatise of Government. John Locke, 1689. Avalon Project, Yale Law School. Public domain. https://avalon.law.yale.edu/17th_century/locke.asp

Magna Carta, Clause 39. King John of England, 1215. The National Archives (UK). Public domain. <https://www.bl.uk/magna-carta>

GC.02 — The Declaration of Independence

Declaration of Independence. Continental Congress (drafted by Thomas Jefferson), July 4, 1776. National Archives. Public domain. <https://www.archives.gov/founding-docs/declaration-transcript>

Declaration of Independence (grievance). Continental Congress, July 4, 1776. National Archives. Public domain. <https://www.archives.gov/founding-docs/declaration-transcript>

GC.03 — The Articles of Confederation

Articles of Confederation, Article II. Second Continental Congress, ratified 1781. Avalon Project, Yale Law School. Public domain. https://avalon.law.yale.edu/18th_century/artconf.asp

Letter on Shays's Rebellion. George Washington, 1786. National Archives, Founders Online. Public domain. <https://founders.archives.gov>

GC.04 — The Constitutional Convention & Ratification

Federalist No. 10. James Madison (Publius), 1787. Congress.gov / Library of Congress. Public domain. <https://guides.loc.gov/federalist-papers/text-1-10>

Brutus No. 1 (Anti-Federalist). 'Brutus' (likely Robert Yates), 1787. Teaching American History / Avalon Project. Public domain. <https://teachingamericanhistory.org/document/brutus-i/>

GC.05 — The Preamble: Purposes of Government

Preamble to the U.S. Constitution. Constitutional Convention, 1787. National Archives. Public domain. <https://www.archives.gov/founding-docs/constitution-transcript>

Federalist No. 51. James Madison (Publius), 1788. Congress.gov / Library of Congress. Public domain. <https://guides.loc.gov/federalist-papers/text-51-60>

GC.06 — Principles of Limited Government

Federalist No. 51. James Madison (Publius), 1788. Congress.gov / Library of Congress. Public domain. <https://guides.loc.gov/federalist-papers/text-51-60>

Federalist No. 78. Alexander Hamilton (Publius), 1788. Congress.gov / Library of Congress. Public domain. <https://guides.loc.gov/federalist-papers/text-71-85>

GC.07 — Structure of the Constitution & How to Amend It

U.S. Constitution, Article V. Constitutional Convention, 1787. National Archives. Public domain. <https://www.archives.gov/founding-docs/constitution-transcript>

U.S. Constitution, structure. Constitutional Convention, 1787. National Archives. Public domain. <https://www.archives.gov/founding-docs/constitution-transcript>

GC.08 — The Bill of Rights

First Amendment. U.S. Congress (Bill of Rights), ratified 1791. National Archives. Public domain. <https://www.archives.gov/founding-docs/bill-of-rights-transcript>

Tenth Amendment. U.S. Congress (Bill of Rights), ratified 1791. National Archives. Public domain. <https://www.archives.gov/founding-docs/bill-of-rights-transcript>

GC.09 — Republic and Democracy

Federalist No. 10. James Madison (Publius), 1787. Congress.gov / Library of Congress. Public domain. <https://guides.loc.gov/federalist-papers/text-1-10>

U.S. Constitution, Article IV, Section 4. Constitutional Convention, 1787. National Archives. Public domain. <https://www.archives.gov/founding-docs/constitution-transcript>

Whose Voice Counted? Perspectives on the Founding

This section complicates the founding narrative: whose interests the new government served, who was left out, and who organized in response. It is Government Hack-authored instructional synthesis grounded in this unit's sourced record — not a primary source.

Federalists

Argued for a stronger national union and ratification; Madison and Hamilton defended checks and balances and the large republic in the Federalist Papers (GC.04, GC.06).

Anti-Federalists

Feared a distant, too-powerful central government and refused to ratify without a Bill of Rights to protect individual liberty (GC.04, GC.08).

Enslaved & Free Black Americans

The Three-Fifths Compromise counted enslaved people as three-fifths of a person for representation (GC.04), even as the Declaration proclaimed that 'all men are created equal' (GC.02).

Women & the Unenfranchised

Women, most non-property holders, and Native peoples could not vote at ratification; the Article V amendment process (GC.07) later became the path to expand the franchise.

Unit Reflection

Return to the unit's big question: How and why did the Founders build a limited constitutional republic? Write a final claim with two pieces of evidence from different standards.

Part	Write here
My claim	
Evidence 1 (standard: __)	
Evidence 2 (standard: __)	
Why it matters today	